

EMMA.J SEBIT



DEBATE FOUNDATION

FOR SECONDARY &
PRIMARY SCHOOLS

VOL 1



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Comments

I will be glad to receive your comments about this book.
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“Put your mouth where your money is.”

– Prove your point with action



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*“Plays devil advocate.” – Argue against an idea
to test its validity*

BRIGHT EMERALD COMPUTER CENTER (BECC)



Painting Workshop

Doha, Juba city

*“Turn the tables.” – Reverse a situation to gain an
advantage*

Acknowledgments

Writing **Debate Foundation**: Volume 1 has been a deeply rewarding journey, and I could not have accomplished it without the support and guidance of several incredible individuals like Francis Okot Augustino, Ajok Isaiah, Modong Grace and all the staff members of St. Mary's.

First and foremost, I want to express my heartfelt gratitude to my mentors and teachers who instilled in me a love for debate and critical thinking. Your wisdom and encouragement have been invaluable in shaping this work.

To my family and friends, thank you for your unwavering support and patience throughout the writing process. Your belief in my vision kept me motivated even during the most challenging moments.

I am also deeply grateful to my peers in the debating community, whose insights and feedback have enriched this book. Your passion and dedication inspire me every day.

Finally, I extend my thanks to my readers—both aspiring and seasoned debaters. This book is for you, and I hope it serves as a valuable resource on your journey to mastering the art of debate.

Thank you all for being a part of this journey.

With gratitude,

EMMANUEL SEBIT JOSEPH

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Emmanuel Sebit Joseph". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Dedication

To the curious minds who seek clarity in chaos,

To the fearless voices that challenge the status quo,

And to the silent listeners who find strength in
understanding—

This book is for you.

May it ignite your passion for truth, sharpen your
reasoning, and empower you to inspire change through
the art of debate.

Preface

Debating is more than an exchange of words—it is a discipline of the mind, a test of character, and a pathway to meaningful discourse. In today’s world, where opinions often collide and perspectives are plentiful, the ability to debate effectively is an indispensable skill.

Debate Foundation: Volume 1 was born out of a vision to empower individuals—students, professionals, and enthusiasts alike—to master the fundamentals of this essential art. This book provides a solid foundation for understanding the structure, strategies, and techniques of debating, making it accessible to beginners while offering fresh insights for those seeking to refine their skills.

Throughout this volume, I have distilled years of experience in competitive debating, coaching, and research into practical tools and examples that can be applied in any setting. Whether you are preparing for a formal competition, improving your public speaking, or simply seeking to become a more persuasive communicator, this book is designed to guide you every step of the way.

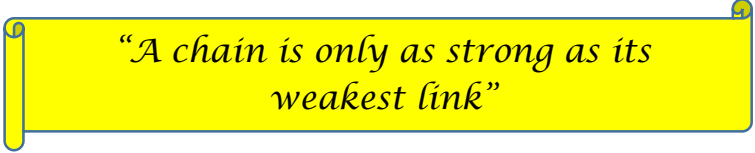
Writing this book has been a deeply enriching journey, and my hope is that it will inspire a new generation of critical thinkers and confident speakers. Debate is not just about winning an argument—it is about fostering understanding, embracing diversity of thought, and finding common ground amidst differences.

As you embark on this journey through **Debate Foundation: Volume 1**, I encourage you to approach each chapter with an open mind and a willingness to challenge yourself. The skills you develop here will not only serve you in debates but also in life.

Thank you for allowing me to be a part of your journey. Together, let us lay the foundation for success in the world of debate.

EMMANUEL SEBIT JOSEPH

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“A chain is only as strong as its weakest link”

Foreword

Debate is the cornerstone of progress, the engine of innovation, and the heartbeat of democracy. Throughout history, the art of debate has shaped societies, resolved conflicts, and inspired change. It is not merely an academic exercise but a profound skill that empowers individuals to articulate their thoughts, challenge assumptions, and persuade with conviction.

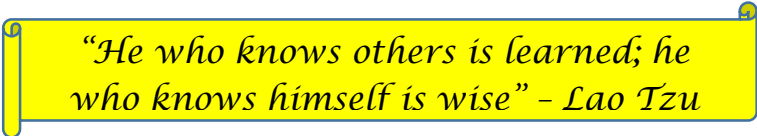
Debate Foundation: Volume 1 is a timely and invaluable resource for anyone seeking to master this transformative art. In this volume, Emmanuel Sebit Joseph has skillfully laid out the building blocks of debate, providing a comprehensive guide that balances theoretical understanding with practical application. The clarity of the explanations, coupled with engaging examples, ensures that this book resonates with both novices and experienced debaters.

What sets this book apart is its focus on fostering critical thinking and empathy—qualities that lie at the heart of effective communication. By reading and applying the principles outlined in this book, you will not only become a better debater but also a more insightful thinker and a more compelling advocate for your beliefs.

I have witnessed firsthand the power of debate to transform individuals, instill confidence, and build bridges of understanding. As someone who has long been passionate about the art of debate, I am confident that this book will inspire readers to embrace the challenges and rewards of this discipline.

Debate Foundation: Volume 1 is more than a guide—it is an invitation to engage in meaningful dialogue, to listen as much as you speak, and to contribute thoughtfully to the conversations that shape our world. I commend Emmanuel Sebit Joseph for creating a work that is both practical and profound, and I encourage readers to approach this book not just as a manual, but as a companion on their journey to mastering the art of debate.

JM Stanley



“He who knows others is learned; he who knows himself is wise” – Lao Tzu

Introduction

Debate is not just an art—it is a powerful tool for navigating the complexities of life. Whether you're defending a stance, analyzing an issue, or persuading an audience, the ability to articulate your thoughts effectively can set you apart in every sphere of life.

Yet, for many, debate feels daunting. Questions arise: Where do I begin? How do I structure my arguments? What if I face a stronger opponent? These uncertainties often discourage aspiring debaters from exploring their potential. This book, **Debate Foundation: Volume 1**, is designed to eliminate those fears and provide you with the confidence to take your first steps into the world of debating.

In these pages, you will uncover the fundamental principles of debate, practical techniques to craft and deliver compelling arguments, and strategies to handle rebuttals with precision. From understanding debate formats to mastering the art of persuasion, this book offers a comprehensive guide tailored for beginners and intermediate debaters alike.

But this is not just about winning debates. It is about cultivating critical thinking, learning to view issues from multiple perspectives, and sharpening your communication skills—abilities that extend far beyond the debate stage.

As you journey through **Debate Foundation: Volume 1**, you will encounter:

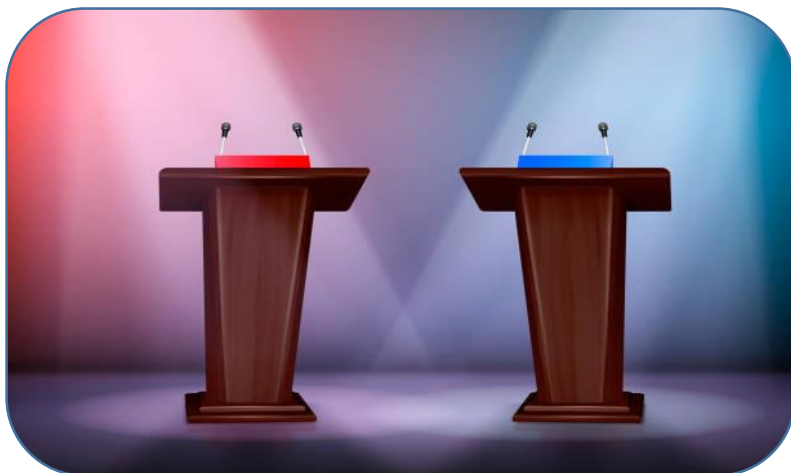
- ✓ Clear explanations of key concepts and techniques.
- ✓ Real-world examples to illustrate ideas in action.
- ✓ Practical exercises to build and refine your skills.

This book is more than a guide—it is an invitation to challenge yourself. It invites you to think critically, express confidently, and grow intellectually. Debate is not just for competitions or classrooms; it is for anyone who believes in the power of words to inspire change and create impact.

So, whether you are a student preparing for your first debate, a professional looking to sharpen your persuasive skills, or someone curious about the art of argumentation, this book is your foundation.

Let's embark on this exciting journey together and unlock the debater within you.

Welcome to **Debate Foundation: Volume 1**. Let the dialogue begin.



Name: _____

Home address: _____

Home telephone: _____

Mobile: _____

Email: _____

GOALS FOR THE MONTH

WHAT IS DEBATING

Learning Objectives

This module provides a general introduction to the concept of debating.

At the end of this module, debaters should be able to:

- ✦ Understand the concept of debate, its purposes, and benefits
- ✦ Learn the different types of debate and the key terms used
- ✦ Familiarize themselves with the most common debate formats



Introduction

We live in a world where we communicate with others all the time. Debating is a more formal way of communicating. It builds confidence and self-esteem, and develops critical thinking and reasoning skills. If we can speak publicly and convey our ideas and thoughts coherently, we have a valuable tool that can aid us in our public, private and future lives.

A debate is a formal discussion on a particular matter in a public event, a legislative assembly, or simply in a formal gathering of a group of people, in which there are two sides: each side is entitled to prove their point through developing multiple arguments and refuting those of the opponent side.

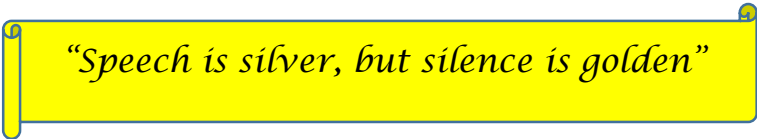
Depending on the chosen format, the debate usually ends with an adjudication delivered by a specialized committee or by the audience vote.

Debaters get the chance to express themselves on a given topic in a formal manner. They learn the techniques to defend their case, question the opponent's arguments, and defend themselves when contradicted.

In case the debaters' positions are chosen by a toss, it is the duty of the debater to adhere to the position assigned to him/her, regardless of his/her personal opinions.

The purpose of a Debate is to set forth on a quest to unravel the better truth amongst the various facets of the truth brought forth by the debaters. This is to be done by realizing that there is no one totalitarian truth but a better truth that is born of the discussion. Debating is not just about addressing the problems; it aims at arriving at a conclusive notion about a certain issue and providing the most suitable solutions and mechanisms

Debating is different to public speaking because it includes rebuttal; proving that the opposition has arguments that are wrong.



"Speech is silver, but silence is golden"

THE BENEFITS OF DEBATE

Competitive debate is a challenging and highly rewarding activity for most who become involved in it. There are a full range of benefits associated with being on the debate team.

- **Fun:** The vast majority of the tens of thousands of students who compete in debate tournaments each year will tell you that it's fun. For every person, the experience is a little different, but generally the thrill of competition, the camaraderie of teammates and the travel opportunities make debate fun.
- **Teammates:** An additional benefit of getting involved is building friendships with teammates who enjoy similar interests.
- **Public Speaking Skills:** Most people naturally avoid public speaking--debate provides a nonthreatening environment to practice these skills so that down the road when you're called on to speak in college or on the job, you'll have the skills necessary to do a great job. This increases your chances of doing well in important interviews for jobs or scholarships.
- **Analytical Skills:** The ability to critically analyze a problem and propose workable solutions is invaluable. This is a skill

that debate best teaches and high-level business people and professionals possess.

- **Research Skills:** From traditional library research to the Internet, debate teaches you to become a world-class researcher. Ask any college student and they'll tell you how valuable this is.
- **Listening & Note taking Skills:** Debate requires that you become a careful listener and good note taker. This helps students get better grades and learn faster. Many of this nation's top lawyers, business executives, doctors, engineers, and elected leaders were involved in high school debate, and for good reason. Simply put, debate-related skills help one get ahead and stay there. The power to persuade is highly respected and there is no better way to master this art than through debate.



THE RESOLUTION

The debate resolution is the focus for the debate. A resolution is a controversial statement that can be supported or opposed. Resolutions can be statements of fact, policy, or value. The affirmative team always supports (affirms) the resolution. The negative team opposes (negates) the resolution.

Type of Motion	What is involved?	Example
Fact	Motions where the teams make a judgement on the subject of the motion; whether something is or is not.	This House Believes That climate change is the biggest threat to humankind.
Judgement	Motions comparing two opposing views or philosophies.	This House Believes That the environment is more important than the economy.
Value	Motions which consider whether something is of inherent value or not.	This House Believes That veganism is the best way to live.
Policy	Motions which indicate that some sort of policy or action needs to be made, in order to solve a problem. The proposition must outline a specific plan of action in accordance with the motion; they must show that the policy is needed and that it is effective. The opposition, meanwhile, will attack the motion and show why the policy is not needed and not effective.	This House Will ban child marriage.

ROLES OF DIFFERENT PERSONNEL IN DEBATE

1. Chairperson

A debate has a Chairman/lady who conducts the debate and a timekeeper who records the time of each speaker.

2. Timekeeper

Monitor time and gives a warning and elapse of time signal to the speakers. A timekeeper's role is majorly to ensure that time is kept by each speaker.

3. Audience

Listen to the speakers and give moral to the team of their interest.

4. The Role of the Judge

Each debate round will have a judge who will decide which team does the better job of debating.

The judge is instructed to base his/her decision on the arguments made in the debate round, not on his/her personal beliefs about the issues. Usually, a judge will take notes and do his or her best to follow all of the arguments you make. At the conclusion of the debate, the judge will write a ballot which explains his/her decision. You will get your ballot back at the end of the tournament.

Judges are hired by the schools that attend a debate tournament. They may be teachers, parents, former high school debaters, or other interested adults.

Some judges are very experienced, but many are not. Undoubtedly, at some point in your debate career you will be disappointed by a decision that a judge makes. It is best to assume that your judge is doing their best. Remember, debate is subjective and will be seen differently by different people.

Score	Notion
65	Is the lowest score a debater can obtain. This score is given to debaters who violate the corresponding laws and ethics of the debate. For example, he/she does not talk at all or insults another debater, team, adjudicator, or entity.
66-69	This is a below average performance. This score is given to debaters who understand the debate but do not master the essential debating skills. The speech is outside the scope of the debate although the debater tries to play his/her role as a speaker. The debater presents a speech with no focus on content or delving into the aspects of the debate. Debater missed major parts of the judging flowchart.
70-73	This is an average performance. This score is given to debaters who understand their role as a speaker and the aim of the speech; however, they are unable to adapt the content and delivery to serve this goal. They master some roles while not mastering others. Debater missed parts of the judging flowchart.
74-77	This is an above average performance This score is given to debaters who are capable of playing their roles as a speaker on all levels. He/she represents the team's stance and goal. Debater fulfils most parts of the judging flowchart.
78-81	This score is given to debaters who are capable of playing their roles as a speaker on all levels in addition to prevailing an understanding of general knowledge. All roles are mastered, and the content is adequate to form a public opinion on the subject. Debater fulfils all parts of the judging flowchart.
82-85	This score is given to debaters who are capable of playing their roles as a speaker on all levels in addition to prevailing expertise on the motion at hand. All roles are mastered, and the content of the speech shows deep expertise in addition to exceptional presentation/style. Debater fulfils all parts of the judging flowchart.

“A wise man hears one word and understands two”

5. Teams

There are two teams:

- a) **An Affirmative** – the team that agrees with the topic;
and
- b) **A Negative** – the team that disagrees with the topic.

Each side consists of three members; first, second and third speakers.

The First Affirmative speaker begins the debate. When s/he is finished and returns to her/his seat, the first Negative speaker comes forward. Then, the Second Affirmative speaks next, followed by the Second Negative, and finally, the Third Affirmative, and the Third Negative.

Each speaker speaks for a set time, with a warning bell from the timekeeper ringing once 30 seconds before the finish of the debate, giving the debater a little time to sum up and finish, followed by a final bell, which rings twice.

Each debater may speak 30 seconds after the final bell, however a continuous bell will ring after that and the speaker may then be penalized.

- ★ Each speaker has certain ‘duties’ to attend to as they speak (see ‘**Duties of Speakers**’).

- ✦ All debaters must begin with salutation e.g. “Good afternoon (or evening) Madam/Mr. Chairman, Ladies and Gentlemen”.
- ✦ Arrive 15 minutes before the debate.

Affirmative teams provide a Chairman while Negative teams provide a timekeeper.

The Affirmative team collects all the paperwork for the debate from the front desk, including:

- A Chairman/Timekeeper form
- Speaker Award Certificate
- Newsletters for the room

The Chairman has to fill out two forms:

The Chairman form; and the Adjudicator form with the first and last names of the debaters of both teams, and other information.

The Chairman hands the Adjudicator form and the Debating Award Certificate to the Adjudicator and keeps the Chairman form for themselves.

Speakers should say “**thank you**” when they finish their debate.

When the debate is finished the Adjudicator will give feedback and give a decision on which team has won.

Unless the Adjudicator asks you a question you sit silently, and don't interrupt. A speaker from each team gives a vote of thanks. Each team then shakes hands with the opposition as a gesture of good sportsmanship.

TYPES OF MOTIONS

Motions can be divided according to, structure and substance. The substance of a motion refers to the assertion that the motion adopts and the premises that support that assertion.



“When the debate is lost, slander becomes the tool of the loser” - Socrates

Types of Motion	What is involved?	Example
Fact	Motions where the teams make a judgement on the subject of the motion; whether something is or is not	This House Believes That climate change is the biggest threat to humankind.
Judgement	Motions comparing two opposing views or philosophies	This House Believes That the environment is more important than the economy
Value	Motions which consider whether something is of inherent value or not	This House Believes That veganism is the best way to live.

POSSIBLE MOTIONS FOR DEBATE

1. This house would ban sports betting.
2. THW stop teaching children that all opinions should be respected.
3. THB that democracy is overrated as a governance model.
4. THB that government should implement universal basic income.
5. THB that authoritarian regimes are better at combating climate change than democratic ones.
6. THB that political parties should be banned.
7. THB that countries should have open borders.

8. THB that developing countries should prioritize economic growth over environmental protection.
9. THB that cryptocurrencies are the future of global finance.
10. THB that multinational corporations have more power than nation-states.
11. THB that Wealth redistribution should be prioritize over wealth creation.
12. THB that labor unions are still essentials in the 21st century.
13. THB that cancel culture does more harm than good.
14. THB that societal beauty standards are harmful to self-expression.
15. THB that social media companies should be held liable for misinformation.
16. THB that individuals should have the right to choose euthanasia.
17. THB that artificial intelligence poses a greater threat than benefit to humanity.
18. THB that governments should ban the development of autonomous weapons.
19. THB that internet should be treated as a public utility.

20. THB that the digital divide is the greatest inequality of our time.

21. This house regrets the rise of social media “influencer”

Example

Motion: THBT capital punishment should be abandoned.

Side: Government

Claim: capital punishment is ineffective

Explanation: death does not prevent crimes or deter criminals from committing crimes like killing. Death only affects those who committed the crimes, while others are not deterred from committing similar crimes in the future

Evidence: people still commit killing in countries using death penalty

Link: Since death, as a punishment, does not prevent crimes, it becomes an ineffective punishment, and should be abandoned as it fails to serve its purpose in the protection of society

“Truth stands the test of time; lies are soon expose” – Proverbs 12:19

KEY TERMS

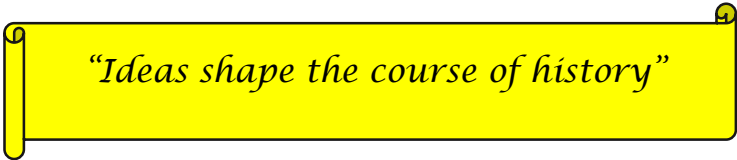
Term	Definition
Motion	The topic of the debate
Format	The structure determining the rules of the debate, number of debaters, length of the speeches, interventions and the role of each speaker
House	Comprises the Adjudicators, Moderators, Debaters, audience, etc.
Government	The team of debaters who support the motion
Opposition	The team of debaters who oppose the motion.
Opening Benches	First two teams of both the government and opposition side: The opening government and the opening opposition.
Closing Benches	Second two teams from both the government and opposition side: The closing government and the closing opposition.
Rebuttal	It is a part of the debater's speech designed to contradict the opponent's arguments, ideas and context.
Refutation	Is proving how an argument or statement is wrong by an argument or by evidence.
Point of Information	A brief comment, which may be a question to an opposing speaker, brief arguments to refute a position, or against the motion in general
Point of Order	A point of order is raised when one competitor believes the rule of the debate are being broken. These must be addressed to the Adjudicators.
Extension	It provides a more extended level of analysis by introducing a new perspective or direction to the debate.
Clash points	The major points of disagreement between the two sides mentioned throughout the debate.
Adjudication	The process by which adjudicators evaluate the debate based on content, style and strategy of speeches. Adjudicator rank teams and assign speaker points to each speaker.
Speaker score	The total number of points to each speaker, Usually on a 65-85 scale.

OTHER DEBATE FORMATS

- There are several different formats of Debate used around the world, but most of these formats share some essential features such as the debate elements (Motion, Argumentation, and Refutation) and the two sides:

A proposition side who will advocate the adoption of a resolution and an opposition side who will refute the resolution.

- The differences are mainly found in the number of debaters, length of the speech, cross-examination periods, order and length of the interventions and rebuttal, role of each debater, technical terms, and adjudication (some formats use votes instead). Some formats were developed for use in secondary school or university programs while other formats are used for public debates or exclusively used for policy motions.



“Ideas shape the course of history”

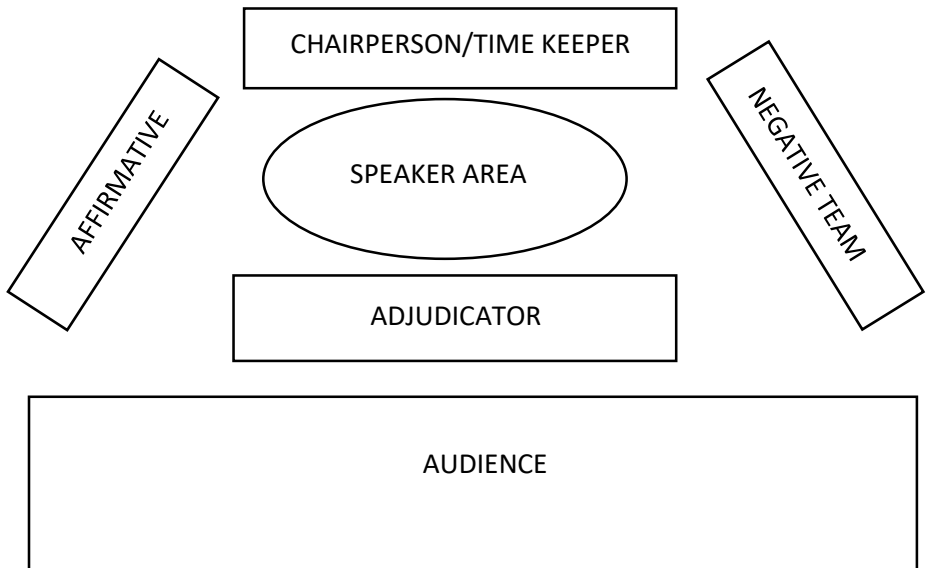
Debate formats include the

- ❖ Oxford Style Debate,
- ❖ Parliamentary Debate,
- ❖ British Parliamentary Debate,
- ❖ Asian Parliamentary Debate,
- ❖ Policy Debate,
- ❖ Harvard Debate,
- ❖ The Lincoln-Douglas Debate,
- ❖ Karl Popper Debate,
- ❖ World Schools Debating Championship,
- ❖ World Universities Debating Championship, etc.



ROOM LAYOUT

A debate is set up as shown in the diagram below



DEBATING CONTENT

Each speaker is awarded a score out of 100 which is divided as follows: -

Argument 50

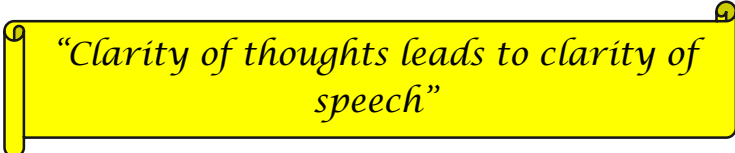
Presentation 30

Structure 20

Argument is the argument, evidence and proof of the team's case and the rebuttal of the other side's case. It also includes the definition and interpretation of the topic.

Presentation is how the speaker presents his/her arguments physically, and includes things like eye contact, gestures, stance, and voice.

Structure is the organization and order of a speaker's speech (see debating template).



“Clarity of thoughts leads to clarity of speech”

DEFINITION AND INTERPRETATION

The definition of the topic consists in the first instance of defining individual or key words of the topic.

The interpretation of the topic is what we understand the words to mean in the context of the topic. For example, in the argument “That cats are better than dogs”, if a team defined “cats” as “tigers and lions” and “dogs” as “foxes and wolves”, although technically, that is a definition from the Dictionary, in this context, we understand it to mean domestic cats and dogs.

The definition and interpretation of the topic should be outlined by the First Affirmative speaker.

The Negative team must either agree or disagree with the Affirmative team’s definition and interpretation.

How to define the topic?

1. Select the key words from the topic and look up their meanings in a range of dictionaries, choosing the most appropriate definition for each word.
2. Interpret the topic.
3. Formulate a sentence or short paragraph explaining what the topic means.

Topic Interpretation

No one side has a right to the definition.

Occasionally, the two teams may have a different interpretation of the topic.

Each team must defend their definition, and attack that of the other team.

You can disagree with the definition, but still attack the arguments in any event.

Attack the opposition's argument with rebuttal with the statement ***“even if we agreed to the topic which we don't, the opposition arguments are wrong because...”***.

A team which adopts a quirky interpretation often has a hard time finding evidence to support its case.

PREPARING YOUR ARGUMENTS

As a debater, it's important that you make points that are clear, relevant and easy to understand. The use of a verbal illustration or an analogy may help you to clarify complicated terms.

In presenting and developing your argument remember to explain what you mean to prove, what the scope and

implication will be, and why it is true with facts and evidence (not just assertions) to support your case.

Debaters often ask how many points they should have. There is no right or wrong answer. However, realize that you have limited time in which to discuss your points.

The more points, the less in-depth each point can be explored.

As you prepare your case you might think about your rebuttal.

Planning

There are a number of things that you can do in preparation for a debate. Below are some suggestions.

-  Assign speaker roles to your members
-  Meet with your team members as often as you can
-  Practice your debate, and record it so you can see what you look like
-  Talk to other people, ask for their help
-  Write out your debate on cue cards in your own words
-  Use a dictionary or thesaurus to improve your vocabulary

Debating is not writing an essay. As you become more experienced try to speak to dot points on your cards instead of writing out everything in full.

During the debate as you listen to the opposition you write rebuttal on your rebuttal cards.

PRESENTATION

Everyone has their own personality and style when it comes to debating but there are some things that need to be considered.



Speaking

A number of things make up how we sound to other people when we speak. These are some of those elements that make up our speech:

Volume

Speaking loudly or softly. There are some venues that are noisy so you will have to speak more loudly. If you are in a big room, you may need to speak up.

Cadence and pitch

The way your voice gets higher and lower as you speak.

Modulation

The variation of the speed of your voice.

Hints

Speak clearly.

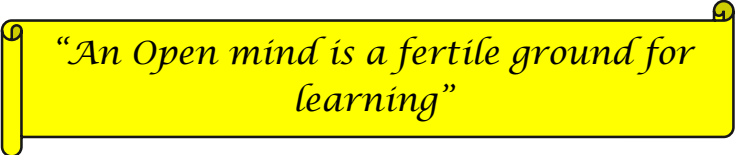
Pronounce words correctly

Don't speak too quickly

Pauses are effective

Avoid “ums” and “errs”

Body language



“An Open mind is a fertile ground for learning”

Stance

How you stand and move your head, eyes and hands, will help to convey your message in a very powerful way. Stand tall, shoulders back. You'll look and feel confident.

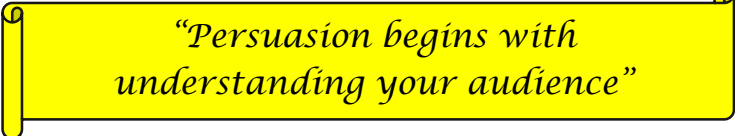
Eye contact

Engage with the audience. Maintain good eye contact by looking at individuals within the audience (this also gives you feedback – are they going to sleep? Do you need to speak with more emotion? They look puzzled. Are you speaking too quickly or softly?)

Hand gestures

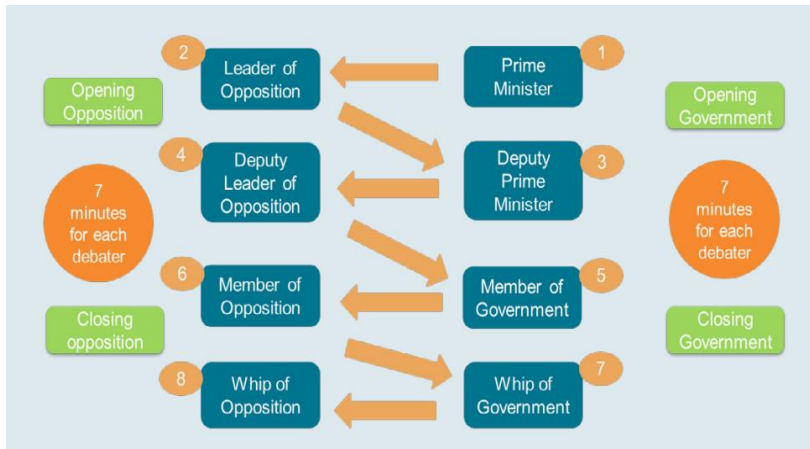
Use your arms and hands to emphasize your points

Make sure that you look neat and tidy in your school uniform. Make sure your socks are pulled up, your shoes are tied and polished and shirts tucked in.



*“Persuasion begins with
understanding your audience”*

ORGAN OF DEBATE



DUTIES OF SPEAKERS - AFFIRMATIVE

1st Speaker

Introduction

Definition and interpretation

Introduction of speakers (also called Team Split)

Arguments, reasons and evidence

Summary of own case

Conclusion (also called Ending)

"To disagree well is to first listen well"

2nd Speaker

Introduction

Rebuttal

Summary of own first speaker.

Arguments, reasons and evidence

Summary of team case

Conclusion (also called Ending)

3rd Speaker

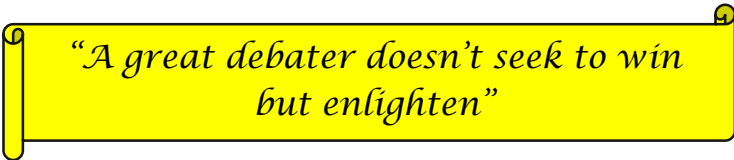
Introduction

Rebuttal

Summary of team arguments and case.

No new arguments except as specific rebuttal.

Conclusion (also called Ending)



*“A great debater doesn’t seek to win
but enlighten”*

DUTIES OF SPEAKERS - NEGATIVE

1st Speaker

Introduction

Definition: agree, amend, or reject definition of Affirmative. If reject, then justify.

Rebuttal

Introduction of speakers (also called Team Split)

Arguments, reasons and evidence

Summary of own case

Conclusion (also called Ending)

2nd Speaker

Introduction

Rebuttal

Summary of own first speaker.

Arguments, reasons and evidence

Summary of team arguments and case

Conclusion (also called Ending)

3rd Speaker

Introduction

Rebuttal

Summary of team case

Conclusion (also called Ending)

No new arguments except as specific rebuttal



"Question everything, but respect the truth"

Some clues;

5. Strategies and Techniques

There are several strategies or techniques for rebuttals and refutations depending on the motion and the statements raised by the opposing team. See the example below to learn some of these techniques.

Example

Motion: This house believes that education in private schools is better than public schools.

Technique 1: Reduce the importance of the other team's statement

Statement: Private schools offer healthier meals when compared to public schools.

Rebuttal: Whether or not this is actually the case, this feature has little or no relevance in any assessment of the quality of education provision.

Technique 2: Identify that a factual assertion is insufficient to prove a point

Statement: Private schools have luxurious buildings.

Rebuttal: This may be true, but it is insufficient to prove that education is better in private schools.

Technique 3: Show an assertion to be false

Statement: Private schools offer scholarships to most of their students.

Rebuttal: This is not true; scholarships are only offered to high achievers.

Technique 4: Look out for generalisations

Statement: Private schools are always the top in all fields.

Rebuttal: This general assertion obscures the fact that public schools have dominated in athletics for the last five years.

Keep in mind that:

- Not all the points presented by the opposing team are equally important, therefore you should focus on responding to the main arguments.
- Be aware of your allocated time so that you can make the best of it.
- You should focus and spend more time on rebutting and refuting the arguments of the speaker who spoke immediately before you. However, you may rebut or refute the arguments of any of the previous speakers in the opposing team.
- Exclamatory questions are not considered rebuttal. It is not enough to oppose or deny a point; you have to demonstrably rebut or refute it.

❖ Reflection Questions

- How well do you feel you have met the overall learning outcome for this module?
- What more will you need to do, in order to become more competent and confident in deploying effective rebuttal and refutation?
- Why is it important for you as a debater to identify logical fallacies?
- What are other refutation techniques that come to your mind?



“Cut to the chase” – Get to the main point

CLASSIC DEBATE LEAGUE

FORMAT AND TIME LIMITS

Affirmative Constructive	6 Minutes	In this prepared speech, the affirmative presents their arguments in favor of the resolution. The speech should be pre-written.
Cross-Examination	3 Minutes	The 1st Negative Speaker cross-examines the 1st Affirmative Speaker
Negative Constructive	6 Minutes	In this prepared speech, the negative presents their arguments in opposition to the resolution. The speech should be pre-written and is not expected to directly address the arguments made during the affirmative constructive.
Cross-Examination	3 Minutes	The 2nd Affirmative Speaker cross-examines the 1st Negative Speaker
1st Negative Rebuttal	5 Minutes	The purpose of this speech is for the 2nd Negative Speaker to refute the arguments presented in the affirmative constructive
Cross-Examination	3 Minutes	The 1st Affirmative Speaker cross-examines the 2nd Negative Speaker
Preparation Time	2 Minutes	
1st Affirmative Rebuttal	7 Minutes	The 2nd Affirmative Speaker should first refute the arguments presented in the negative constructive. Then, the speaker should answer the attacks made during the 1st negative rebuttal
Cross-Examination	3 Minutes	The 2nd Negative Speaker cross-examines the 2nd Affirmative Speaker

Continue in the next page ... >>

Preparation Time	2 Minutes	
2nd Negative Rebuttal	6 Minutes	The 1st Negative Speaker should divide this speech between the negative and affirmative cases. The debater must both rebuild the negative attacks on the affirmative constructive and then rebuild his or her own case.
Preparation Time	2 Minutes	
2nd Affirmative Rebuttal	4 Minutes	The 1st Affirmative Speaker should divide this speech between the negative and affirmative cases. The debater must both rebuild the affirmative attacks on the negative constructive and then rebuild his or her own case.
Preparation Time	2 Minutes	
Negative Summary	3 Minutes	The 2nd Negative Speaker presents their closing argument. This speech should summarize the primary reasons for the judge to reject the resolution based on the arguments made and evidence presented throughout the debate.
Preparation Time	2 Minutes	
Affirmative Summary	3 Minutes	The 2nd Affirmative Speaker presents their closing argument. This speech should summarize the primary reasons for the judge to affirm the resolution based on the arguments made and evidence presented throughout the debate

“The devil’s advocate” – Someone who argues the opposing view to test idea

STEP BY STEP GUIDE (CLASSIC DEBATE)

During the Debate Step by Step

Speech #1: The Affirmative Constructive

Time Limit: 6 Minutes

Purpose: The affirmative team presents their arguments in favor of the resolution.

Speaker: The First Affirmative (1A)

This is a pre-prepared speech which provides the primary affirmative arguments in favor of the resolution. While the affirmative team will be able to answer negative attacks later in the debate, they can't bring up "new" main ideas or arguments in their favor. Therefore, it is very important that the affirmative team carefully plan their constructive speech. The speech should contain the very best arguments in favor of the resolution. These are the arguments the affirmative will defend throughout the debate.

The speech should be written to persuade the judge and/or audience. To be persuasive, the speech should be clearly written, it should be well supported with credible evidence, and it should use persuasive and attention-holding language.

Cross-Examination #1

Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: Question and answer

Participants: The 1st negative speaker asks questions of the 1st affirmative speaker

Cross-examination is an important part of the debate round. This is the only time that debaters interact directly. There are two main purposes of cross-examination.

Purpose #1 Clarification: First, issues or arguments that are unclear should be clarified. Simple questions like, “can you please explain your argument against our third contention?” can be crucial. It is impossible to debate well when you aren’t sure of your opponent’s arguments.

Cross-examination gives you time to clarify any confusion.

Purpose #2 Exposing Flaws: Second, cross-examination allows you to expose weaknesses in your opponent’s arguments or evidence. When executed well, such a cross-examination can be devastating.

Please see the section on cross-examination for more information.

Speech #2: The Negative Constructive

Time Limit: 6 Minutes

Purpose: The negative team presents their arguments in opposition to the resolution.

Speaker: The First Negative (1N)

Just like the affirmative constructive, the negative constructive outlines the main arguments in opposition to the resolution. It is also a pre-prepared speech, meaning it is not expected to directly answer the arguments made in the affirmative constructive. After the two constructive speeches, each team has presented a set of arguments in their favor. The next logical step is for the two teams to begin to directly attack the arguments made by their opponents.

Cross-Examination #2

Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: Question and answer

Participants: The 2nd affirmative speaker asks questions of the 1st negative speaker

Speech #3: The 1st Negative Rebuttal

Time Limit: 5 Minutes

Purpose: The negative team refutes the affirmative constructive.

Speaker: The Second Negative (2N)

While the 1N delivers the negative constructive, the 2N gets to plan their attack against the affirmative constructive. In this speech, the negative team presents their refutation (answers to) the affirmative constructive. The goal of the negatives is to disprove, or at least minimize, the affirmative arguments.

Cross-Examination #3

Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: Question and answer

Participants: The 1st affirmative speaker asks questions of the 2nd negative speaker



“Hit the nail on the head” – To state something exactly and effectively

Preparation Time: 2 Minutes. All debaters are given 2 minutes at this time to prepare for future speeches. This is especially important for the 2nd affirmative speaker who will give the next speech.

Speech #4: The 1st Affirmative Rebuttal

Time Limit: 7 Minutes

Purpose: The affirmative team refutes the negative constructive AND rebuilds their case.

Speaker: The Second Affirmative (2A)

The first affirmative rebuttal is one of the most challenging speeches in the debate because it requires the 2A to do two things. First, he/she must refute the arguments made during the negative constructive (just as the 2N just refuted the arguments made during the affirmative constructive). Next, he/she must rebuild the affirmative case which was just attacked. The first affirmative rebuttal is the longest speech of the debate, but the time must be carefully divided between the two tasks. It is up to the 2A to decide how to divide the time.



Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: Question and answer

Participants: The 2nd Negative Speaker cross-examines the 2nd Affirmative Speaker

Preparation Time: 2 Minutes

Speech #5: The 2nd Negative Rebuttal

Time Limit: 6 Minutes

Purpose: To rebuild the attacks on the affirmative case and to rebuild the negative case.

Speaker: The First Negative (1N) Now it is the negative team's turn to balance time on both cases. This is the negative's last chance before the summary to clarify, defend, and strengthen their argument's. The first negative speaker should defend the negative case and rebuild the negative attack against the affirmative. The negative team should begin to focus on the critical issues of the debate. There is not time to go into great detail over every issue in the debate.



"The ball is in your coat" – It's your turn to take action or respond

Preparation Time: 2 Minutes

Speech #6: The 2nd Affirmative Rebuttal

Time Limit: 4 Minutes

Purpose: To rebuild the attacks on the negative case and to rebuild the affirmative case.

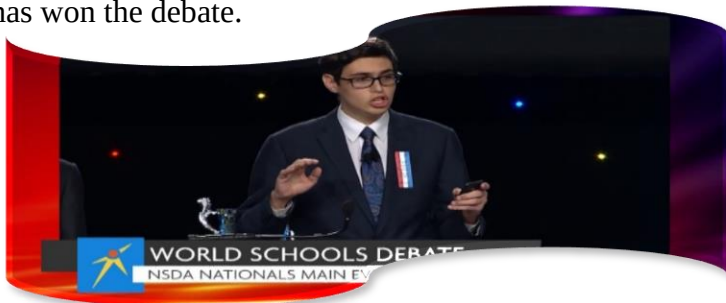
Speaker: The First Affirmative (1A) The affirmative now gets their last chance before the summary to clarify, defend, and strengthen their arguments. This rebuttal is 2 minutes shorter than the 2nd negative rebuttal, so the affirmative team must continue the focus on the critical issues of the debate.

Preparation Time: 2 Minutes

Speech #7: The Negative Summary

Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: To summarize the reasons why the negative team has won the debate.



Speaker: The Second Negative (2N)

The summary is, of course, the final opportunity to persuade the judge to reject the resolution. Rather than going issue by issue through both cases, the summary should crystallize the debate into several main arguments for the judge to consider. These arguments should be the key issues in determining the winner of the debate.

Preparation Time: 2 Minutes

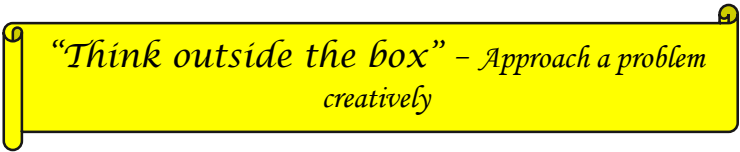
Speech #8: The Affirmative Summary

Time Limit: 3 Minutes

Purpose: To summarize the reasons why the negative team has won the debate.

Speaker: The Second Affirmative (2A)

The affirmative summary is the final opportunity to persuade the judge to support the resolution. Rather than going issue by issue through both cases, the summary should crystallize the debate into several main arguments for the judge to consider. These arguments should be the key issues in determining the winner of the debate.



“Think outside the box” – Approach a problem creatively

SUMMARY OF RESPONSIBILITIES

During the debater, each speaker will give 2 speeches. He or she will also participate in 2 cross examinations, one as the questioner and one as the person who is questioned. Here is a summary of each person's responsibility through the debate.

First Affirmative (1A)

Affirmative Constructive

Answer questions of 2N

Question 2N after 1st Negative Rebuttal

2nd Affirmative Rebuttal

Second Affirmative (2A)

Question 1N after Negative Constructive

1st Affirmative Rebuttal

Answer questions of 1N

Affirmative Summary



First Negative (1N)

Negative Constructive

Answers questions of 2A

Question 2A after 1st Affirmative Rebuttal

2nd Negative Rebuttal

Second Negative (2N)

Question 1A after Affirmative Constructive

1st Negative Rebuttal

Answer questions of 1A

Negative Summary

After the Debate

- Immediately after the debate, it is customary for both teams to shake hands.
- Any evidence or materials that may have been borrowed during the debate should be returned.
- Occasionally, the judge will have a few brief comments for the debaters, which of course, should be listened to respectfully.

- Finally, all debaters should clean up their materials and move to their next debate. If you are competing in the last debate of the day, be sure to rearrange desks or tables that have been moved. Please help the tournament host by making sure any trash is disposed of.

WRITING YOUR CONSTRUCTIVE SPEECHES

As you already know, your team will present a six-minute constructive speech during each debate. The purpose of the constructive speech is to make and support your main arguments in favor of the resolution (when you are affirmative) or against the resolution (when you are negative).

Your constructive speech should always accomplish the following:



- ❖ It will present your primary arguments
- ❖ It will provide support for those arguments in the form of evidence and reasoning
- ❖ It should be persuasively written (should include introduction, transitions, & a conclusion)

“Raise the bar” – Set a higher standard

Beyond those basic guidelines, you have the freedom to create a case that makes sense to you and that you believe will persuade the judge. Let's take a closer look at some of the basic requirements.

The Introduction

Your case should always begin with an introduction. The introduction needs to accomplish two things.

- 1) State the resolution and your position (in favor of it or opposed to it)
- 2) Provide a persuasive attention-getter to encourage the audience to listen to your speech.



“Read between the lines.” – Understand the implied or hidden meaning

Sample:

“Every year in South Sudan, our government executes dozens of convicted murderers. Their crimes are so terrible, that our legal system assigns death as the ultimate punishment. What is truly tragic and hypocritical is that every so often our legal system gets the wrong person. Instead of punishing someone for taking an innocent life, it is our government itself that is taking an innocent life. Because my partner and I believe that this should never happen again, we stand Resolved that the death penalty should be abolished in South Sudan. First, we’ll prove that the death penalty results in miscarriages of justice...”

Good Argument Checklist

	The argument is valid, logical, and relevant to the motion and team stance.
	The claim is precise and concise.
	The claim is explained enough to become understandable by a 5-year-old kid.
	Evidence used is strong and credible.
	A link is successfully established between all elements and the motion.
	All elements are fulfilled = concrete structure.
	Argument does not repeat itself and is connected to other arguments, rebuttals, and POI.



THE CONTENTIONS

Your main arguments are called contentions. They should be labeled as Contentions and numbered (traditionally Roman Numerals are used because this follows the outline format).

Your contentions are statements that must be proven.

Sample:

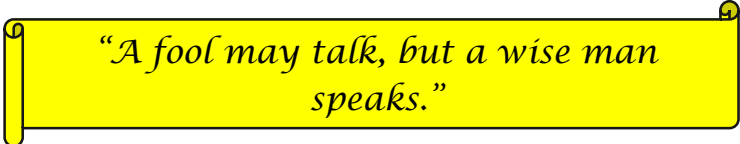
“Contention I. Innocent People Are Wrongly Executed”

After you have stated your Contention, you must provide reasoning and evidence to support it.

The length of the Contention is up to you (you only have 6 minutes, so they will be fairly brief).

Also, the number of Contentions that you have is up to you. Usually, a case will have 2 to 4 main contentions.

You may choose to further divide your contentions into sub-points. Sub-points should be labeled with capital letters (following the outline format). Sub-points provide additional organizational structure to help clarify your argument.



“A fool may talk, but a wise man speaks.”

Sample:

“In today’s debate, the affirmative team has proven that the death penalty results in two major harms to society. First, innocent people are sometimes wrongly executed. Second, the death penalty is discriminatory because it is used more frequently against minorities. Finally, we have shown that the death penalty has no major benefit because it does not reduce crime rates. In light of this evidence, the right thing to do is to abolish this unfair and ineffective punishment. I am now open for cross-examination.”

SUMMARY SPEECHES

The final speeches of the debate should be used to synthesize various arguments into a few critical points for the judge to consider.

One might introduce their summary with a statement like “in light of the arguments made in today’s debate, we have upheld the resolution because...”

This summary statement is difficult for several reasons. First, because of the general nature of the closing argument, the speaker must focus on the “big picture” and less on specific details.

Second, the speaker must extend his/her best arguments while answering his/her opponent's best arguments. This requires a careful balance. Of course, each round of debate will lead to unique summary statements. However, here are some general tips for making successful summary statements.

1) Ask yourself, what are our most powerful arguments? After selecting your most powerful arguments you must explain why you have won these arguments and why this means you have won the debate. In other words, explain the impact of your best arguments.

2) Ask yourself, "what are the weaknesses in my opponent's best arguments?" Explain these weaknesses to the judge.

3) The summary must be an extension of the debate. It should show what your team has accomplished during the debate. It should not be new ideas or perspectives that haven't been brought up.

4) The summary should set up a decision-making criteria for the judge. What factors should be given the most weight in making a decision? For example, let's say that the affirmative has proven that adopting the resolution will

save a species from extinction. The negative team, on the other hand, is able to prove that adopting the resolution would cost South Sudan \$10 Billion.

In this debate, the two sides would have to weigh saving a species to spending billions of dollars. It is your job as a debater to provide analysis that helps the judge arrive at his or her decision.

CROSS-EXAMINATION

Cross-examination serves three important purposes in the debate. It gives one side the chance to clarify the arguments and evidence presented by the other. Secondly, it is an opportunity to demonstrate flaws in the opponent's arguments.

Thirdly, cross-examination is the time when the audience and judge have a chance to see the debaters interact with each other. In other words, cross-examination is a chance to gain the judge's favor.

In cross-examination, both participants face the judge rather than each other. This is because the questions are intended for the audience.

The keys to effective cross-examination are good questions and a professional demeanor. Specifically:

1. Ask specific questions that get to the heart of the issue.
2. Be polite, professional, and respectful during cross-examination.
3. Never personalize cross-examination—the focus should always be on issues.

One of the best ways to improve your cross-examination performance is to improve your topic knowledge. The more you know about the topic, the easier you will find it to ask insightful questions and provide effective answers in cross-examination.

CONCLUSION

If you are new to classic Debate, it is quite normal to be confused by the format. Most beginning debaters have trouble remembering what to do in each speech. There is a simple solution: practice! Once you have been through a few debates, the format will be very easy to remember and you can focus on building better arguments, improving your delivery, and gathering evidence.

REFUTATION

Refutation is the process of disproving an argument. Not all of your opponent's arguments require refutation. There are generally three ways to answer an argument. First, you may simply agree with it. Second, you can partially agree but modify (e.g. "we agree that air pollution causes health problems, however, you overstate the impact"). Thirdly, you can refute the argument (prove it wrong).



*"Wisdom is better than strength." -
Ecclesiastes 9:16*

5. Strategies and Techniques

There are several strategies or techniques for rebuttals and refutations depending on the motion and the statements raised by the opposing team. See the example below to learn some of these techniques.

Example

Motion: This house believes that education in private schools is better than public schools.

Technique 1: Reduce the importance of the other team's statement

Statement: Private schools offer healthier meals when compared to public schools.

Rebuttal: Whether or not this is actually the case, this feature has little or no relevance in any assessment of the quality of education provision.

Technique 2: Identify that a factual assertion is insufficient to prove a point

Statement: Private schools have luxurious buildings.

Rebuttal: This may be true, but it is insufficient to prove that education is better in private schools.

Technique 3: Show an assertion to be false

Statement: Private schools offer scholarships to most of their students.

Rebuttal: This is not true; scholarships are only offered to high achievers.

Technique 4: Look out for generalisations

Statement: Private schools are always the top in all fields.

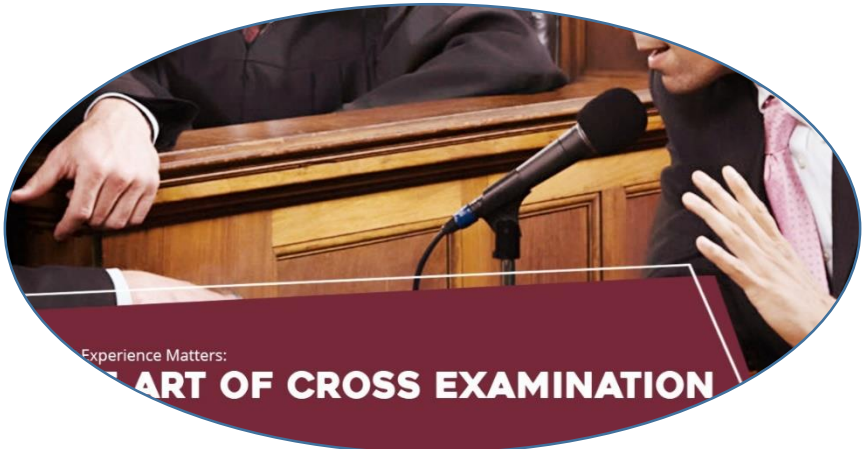
Rebuttal: This general assertion obscures the fact that public schools have dominated in athletics for the last five years.

Keep in mind that:

- Not all the points presented by the opposing team are equally important, therefore you should focus on responding to the main arguments.
- Be aware of your allocated time so that you can make the best of it.
- You should focus and spend more time on rebutting and refuting the arguments of the speaker who spoke immediately before you. However, you may rebut or refute the arguments of any of the previous speakers in the opposing team.
- Exclamatory questions are not considered rebuttal. It is not enough to oppose or deny a point; you have to demonstrably rebut or refute it.

❖ Reflection Questions

- How well do you feel you have met the overall learning outcome for this module?
- What more will you need to do, in order to become more competent and confident in deploying effective rebuttal and refutation?
- Why is it important for you as a debater to identify logical fallacies?
- What are other refutation techniques that come to your mind?



Let's look at how each method may be used effectively

Agreement

Why would you want to agree with an argument made by your opponent? There are three main reasons.

1. Occasionally, your opponent may make an argument that actually helps you. In this case, simply explain to the judge why the argument actually supports your position.
2. Your opponent's argument may be irrelevant to the debate. In this case, explain why the argument is irrelevant.
3. Your opponent's argument may be true. If you know that your opponent has made a true argument, it may not be worth your time fighting against it. Instead, you may grant the argument and use your time to explain that while your opponent's individual argument is true, you should still win the debate.

Modification

Often, you will agree with part of your opponent's argument, but will disagree with the amount of weight they try to assign it. This most often happens when you feel that your opponent is exaggerating. **Example:** *"While I agree with my opponent that President Kiir deserves some blame for the faltering South Sudan's economy, the truth is that he only deserves a small share of the blame."*

Refutation

3. Structure of Rebuttal or Refutation



There are several good ways to attack or disprove a debate argument. Here are some effective strategies:

Attack the argument's support: You may explain that the argument lacks adequate support. This may be because of insufficient reasoning, no evidence, poor evidence, or misapplied or miss-tagged evidence.

As you think about how to respond to your opponent, you may ask yourself:

Is the argument supported at all? (If so, continue down the checklist)

Does the evidence match the claim/tag?

Does the evidence have a credible source?

Extension

When you “extend” your argument it means that you are restating and strengthening it in a later speech. To effectively extend an argument, you need to do more than repeat what you said earlier. Often debaters mistake repetition for extension (“if I just say it again, the judge will understand and will vote for me.” Effective extension includes the following:

- 1) Clarification: You must make sure that the judge understands your argument. Be the one who clarifies the debate.
- 2) Presenting additional reasoning and evidence: You simply need to strengthen your position with more (and better) support.
- 3) Add new (additional) argumentation: Sometimes it may be advantageous for you to add new ideas in support of a position. For example, your general position may be that coal harms the environment. In the first affirmative constructive, you argue that coal causes air pollution, acid rain, and global warming. In the first affirmative rebuttal, you may further explain the health impacts of these environmental problems.

Often, extension and refutation go hand in hand and must be carefully blended Does the evidence provide reasoning?

FAQ: Can I bring up “new” arguments in rebuttals?

Debaters often want to know what they can and can’t bring up in rebuttals. The answer is somewhat dependent on the specific round of debate, but here are some general guidelines:

- You are always allowed to directly answer your opponents’ arguments.
- You may extend arguments you made earlier by presenting clarification and additional supporting evidence.
- You should not bring up totally new main ideas in rebuttals. This is unfair to your opponent because they will have less time to refute these new ideas. Imagine a debate in which you are winning all of the major issues. It would be unfair for your opponent to bring up a whole new set of main issues in one of the last speeches of the debate. This is why debaters should not bring up new main arguments in rebuttals.

During the course of a debate, hundreds of arguments are made. Dozens of facts and experts are cited. The issues are complex and interconnected. Because of this complexity, effective organization is absolutely essential to debate. This chapter deals with two aspects of organization within a debate, note-taking and sign-posting.

Delivery

There are at least two requirements for successful debating. First, a debater must have quality arguments. And, second, a debater must effectively communicate their arguments to the judge or audience. The focus of this chapter is on effective communication.

Articulation

Let's start with the basics. If the words you say are not understood by the audience, you are not communicating effectively. To articulate well means to speak clearly and to correctly pronounce the words you use.



Articulation Problems to Watch for:

- Mumbling or slurring (this is usually a result of not pronouncing words carefully).
- Common mispronunciations (gonna instead of going to, cuz instead of because, etc.)

Volume.

Every speaking situation requires the speakers to adjust his or her volume for the circumstances. Of course, a speaker must be loud enough to be clearly heard by the audience. On the other hand, if a speaker is too loud, the audience will become annoyed or uncomfortable. It is a good idea for a speaker to vary his/her volume during the speech to emphasize certain key points. A slight increase or decrease in volume can call attention to an important point the speaker wants to make.

Rate

Like volume, your rate of speech can be too fast or too slow. Very slow speech will bore the audience. On the other hand, delivery that is too rapid will cause the audience to miss important points or maybe even to tune out. Different speaking circumstances call for different rates. For debaters, a good model is the rate of delivery

used by television news reporters. Listen to an anchor on CNN for an idea of an appropriate rate of delivery.

Sometimes debaters will speak at fast rate in order to fit more into their speeches. In some debate formats, this has been taken to an extreme. Because the judges are not evaluating speakers on their delivery skills, debaters in these formats have used extremely rapid delivery.

In Classic Debate, however, judges are specifically instructed to evaluate student's delivery along with their arguments. In fact, judges are instructed to award a loss to a team which speaks at an unnaturally rapid rate which results in a competitive advantage.

Vocal Variety

When you articulate well with an appropriate rate and volume, you ensure that the audience will hear your words. What else can you do to make them want to listen? One key is vocal variety.

A speaker with little variety is often called monotone (or boring!). You can vary your voice by adjusting volume or rate. You can also change your pitch and tone. This is called inflection.

Also, using pauses of different lengths can make your speech easier to listen to.

Posture & Gestures

You want your audience to see you as professional, relaxed, and confident. In order to achieve this positive image, you should pay attention to posture and gestures. The number one rule is don't do things that will distract your audience. Proper speaking posture is simply standing up straight with your feet pointed toward your audience. Avoid slouching, leaning against walls or tables, and pointing your feet to one side or another.

Gestures are more difficult to master. First, your gestures may often be impeded by what you have in your hands—evidence or notes. This is understood to be part of debate. When you are able to gesture, some general rules are:

- Always gesture above the waist
- Gesture to add emphasis. Your gestures should be purposeful.
- Vary your gestures. Avoid repetitive gestures.

Eye Contact

When possible, look your audience straight in the eye. Of course, you will need to look down at your notes and evidence. At the same time, do not spend the majority of your speech looking down. Speakers who look their audience in the eye are found to be more persuasive. You may also get important non-verbal feedback from your audience that you may use to make your speech better. Is the audience interested, confused, having trouble hearing you, agreeing with you? You can learn a lot by looking at your audience. When there is more than a single person in the audience, you should spend time looking at each person.

Appearance

Many consider your appearance to be part of your delivery. Different debate competitions have different dress expectations. At times, you will be asked to dress professionally (like you would for a business interview). Other times, you will be expected to be more “dress-casual.” Your coach will have suggestions for how to dress for competition. Just remember, appearance does make an impact on the audience. Your attire sends a message. What message do you want to send?

Suggestions for Improvement

Practice, practice, practice! Delivery can always be improved. There are many ways to practice.

You can practice by yourself by giving a particular speech several times, concentrating on improving your delivery.

You can practice with teammates by helping evaluate each other.

And, of course, you can practice with a coach, teacher, or parent. Simply give your speech and ask for feedback on delivery. Or, ask for help with a particular component of delivery. The more you practice, the better you will be.

CONCLUSION

Polls show that most Americans fear public speaking more than death! Luckily for you, debate will help you overcome that fear. Like all aspects of debate, your delivery will get better with practice. You will also get used to standing in front of an audience and making an argument. These skills are great to have—just ask anyone in the professional world.

You now know how to make and deliver an argument. Let's turn our attention to adding more credibility to your arguments by citing credible evidence.

RESEARCH & EVIDENCE

It is essential that debaters provide support for the arguments they make. The quality of the support you provide for your arguments is a key to successful debating. One way to support your arguments is with logical reasoning. In addition to reasoning, you will need to provide evidence to support your claims. The focus of this chapter is how to gather, organize, and use evidence in debate.

Let's begin with the assumption that what we personally know is limited. Very few high school students are experts on the topics they will be debating. Therefore, debaters need to use outside sources of information to increase the credible support for their arguments. Usually, debaters will quote directly from a variety of sources.

In preparation for a debate, you will want to gather evidence (quotes) that you feel will support arguments that you plan to make. Because you will be unable to predict the exact arguments that will be made, it is good to have a variety of evidence quotes to use.

Finding evidence requires effective research. You are probably already an experienced researcher. Even so, you

can probably improve your skills by reviewing the following steps in the research process.

RESEARCH PROCESS

Step 1. Formulate research questions. Before you begin any research, you should identify the questions you are trying to answer. It is important to identify research questions rather than topics. A question gives you a specific goal, whereas a topic is too open-ended. A good question is one that meets the following criteria:

- The wording of the question is clear and specific
- The question can be answered
- The answer to the question is meaningful (i.e. the question leads somewhere important)

If you are new to a topic, adjust your questions accordingly. You should begin by building general topic knowledge before trying to answer specific questions. For example, let's say you are learning about Russia's economy. As you begin your research, you may ask "What is the current status of Russia's economy?" As your topic knowledge grows, your questions should be more in-depth: "What

programs does Russia have to encourage foreign investment?”

Step 2. Select a Method. There are a variety of ways to find answers to your questions. Students who try various sources usually find more success and end up with deeper research. Some good methods include:

- ✓ Article databases. Your school library probably has several databases which are easily searchable. You may also have access to more powerful databases like Lexis/Nexis.
- ✓ Specific Internet Sites. You may know of specific sites on the Internet that have excellent resources on your topic.
- ✓ General Internet searches. If you don't know of a specific site that will be helpful, you may try a general Internet Search. Google is a good place to start.
- ✓ Printed materials in the library (most periodicals and newspapers can be found on-line). However, you may find some very helpful printed materials that are not accessible online.
- ✓ Books (advantage: depth; disadvantage: time consuming)

- ✓ Personal interviews (including e-mail requests for information)

Step 3. Keep Trying. Most likely, you won't succeed right away. Research takes perseverance.

If you are not having any luck answering your questions, try new a different method, different key words, or ask for help. Often, you will need to try several different key words before you get what you want. Write down what you have tried and keep going. If your question is “Who are the main contenders for the 2026 election (South Sudan)?” try: presidential elections, 2026 election, candidates for presidency, presidential candidates, presidential hopefuls, etc.

Help falls under two categories: people who know what they are doing and shortcuts that others have created. If you are new to a library, ask the librarian. They will appreciate you having a focused research question. As for shortcuts, check out bibliographies, names mentioned in articles, and references to other publications.

Step 4. Have a system for recording your results. Make sure you have the ability to take something away from your research. Always have a notebook to jot down notes (good

web sites, important names, leads for further research etc.). Furthermore, make sure you are getting full source citations. If you are printing or copying articles, it is a good idea to staple them together and write the full source citation on the top right away. This will avoid confusion later.

MAKING EVIDENCE CARDS

Once you have gathered and read the information necessary to answer your questions, it is time to transform your articles into evidence cards—a format that is easily used within a debate.

When you present evidence in a debate, you actually present three different pieces of information: a tag, a citation, and the body of the evidence. Each part is very important to effectively using the evidence in the debate.

As you read articles, you should look for passages that may be useful during your debates.

When you find such passages, follow this procedure for making evidence “cards.” The term card refers to a 4x6 index card. Debaters used to write their evidence quotes down on index cards.

Today, some debaters still used index cards, but many also simply print their evidence on 8 ½ x 11 pages.

Source Citation & Tag

The excerpt alone is not complete without a source citation and tag. For printed materials a full source citation consists of:

- Author
- Author's Qualifications
- Publication (name of periodical, book, or report)
- Date of Publication
- Page Number(s)



- Author
- Author's Qualifications
- Publication
- Date of Publication
- Name of Computer Service or Network (i.e. Nexis, SIRs, or www address)

If any of this information is not available, the student should make a note. For example, NQA is often used to signify No Qualifications Available. If the information is available, the student has an obligation to correctly provide it with each evidence excerpt.

A tag is like a headline for the excerpt. It should summarize the main idea of the passage using powerful language and a minimum of words (ideally five or less). The tag should not exaggerate the quality of the information it represents. The tag serves two main purposes. First, it allows students to know the contents of a particular piece of evidence at a glance. Second, the tag is often written during a debate in a competitor's notes. It represents the content of the evidence and therefore needs to be accurate and concise (so that it can be easily written).

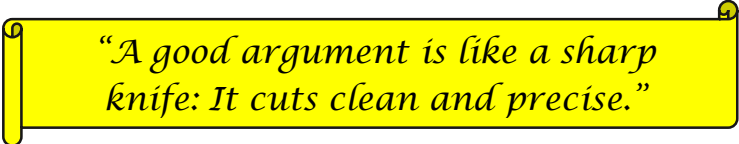
Sample Evidence Card

Bush Plans to Strengthen US Military

Ron Hutcheson & Jodi Enda, Washington Bureau Writers,
St. Paul Pioneer Press, August 22, 2000, p.2A (or
www.pioneerplanet.com)

*In a stinging critique of the Clinton administration's
handling of national defense, George W. Bush said Monday*

that the next president will inherit a military crippled by low morale, muddled missions and inadequate equipment. The Republican presidential candidate used an appearance at the Veterans of Foreign Wars convention to underscore his belief that defense remains a potent issue even a decade after the Cold War ended. “I don’t care what’s said in the political campaign, these are signs of a military in decline and we must do something about it,” Bush said after citing a litany of problems with equipment and recruitment.



“A good argument is like a sharp knife: It cuts clean and precise.”

Your debate case is a six-minute speech that states your team's main arguments for or against the resolution. A case includes an introduction, several main contentions, and a conclusion. Because the judge and other team is trying to flow (take notes on) your case, you should be very clear in stating your main points in outline form. Most main points should be supported by evidence. You may also add your own explanation to support your arguments, but be sure that it's clear to the audience which parts of the case are direct evidence quotes and which parts are your analysis.

Below are tips and samples for each main part of the case. The samples are taken from an affirmative case (“U.S. government’s war on terrorism is making America safer”).

Introduction:

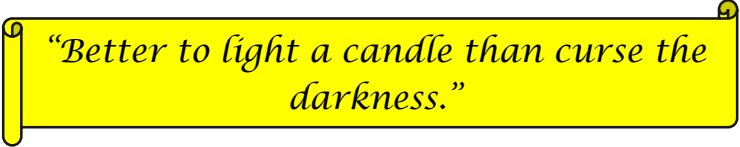
Most cases have a brief introduction. Elements of an introduction usually include:

- An attention getter
- Statement of the resolution and your position
- A brief overview of your thesis
- Definition of ambiguous terms

Sample Introduction:

After the tragic attacks upon the United States on September 11, 2001, we have asked ourselves what went wrong? and how can we fix it? National Commission on Terrorist Attacks Upon the United States thoroughly studied these questions. Recently, the non-partisan commission concluded that “Because of offensive actions against al Qaeda since 9/11, and defensive actions to improve homeland security, we believe we are safer today. But we are not safe.” The affirmative team agrees completely with this conclusion. That is why we stand resolved that the U.S. government’s war on terrorism is making America safer.

We begin our case by showing that before the war on terrorism began after 9-11, we were very vulnerable to attack. Then, in our second and third contentions, we will prove that we are indeed safer today because of the changes we’ve made.



“Better to light a candle than curse the darkness.”

Conclusion:

At the end of your case, a brief conclusion is appropriate:

Sample Conclusion:

In conclusion, we firmly believe that the tremendous effort undertaken by our government to fight terror is having positive results. While we admit that the war on terrorism is far from perfect, it is also clear that we are better prepared to prevent and respond to a terrorist attack than we were 3 years ago.

War on Terrorism

Sample Negative Case

On September 7, 2004, Richard Clarke, the United States' former anti-terrorism chief, was interviewed by two faculty members at the University of California-Berkeley. His remarks included the following: "The Bush administration has bungled the war on terrorism, doing little to provide security at home while breeding legions of new enemies abroad. The pool of people who really hate us is so much greater than it was on 9/11 because of this needless and counterproductive war in Iraq. On the home front, except for improved airline safety, little or nothing has been done

to protect the many other vulnerable targets.” [San Francisco Chronicle, September 8, 2004]. Because my partner and I agree with Clarke’s analysis of the past three years, we stand to negate the resolution, resolved that the U.S. government’s war on terrorism is not making America safer.

To prove that the government’s war on terrorism has not accomplished its goals, we will show that the United States faces major security concerns both at home and abroad.

Contention I: *Anti-terrorism efforts at home have failed to make us safer. The United States remains tragically vulnerable to a terrorist attack on American soil:*

A. Current security measures grossly inadequate Stephen Flynn, Senior Fellow in National Security Studies at the Council on Foreign Relations, Time Magazine, July 26, 2004 [www.time.com September 26, 2004]

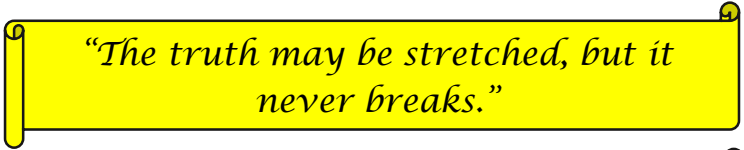
With the exception of airports, much of what is critical to our way of life remains unprotected: water and food supplies; refineries, energy grids and pipelines; bridges, tunnels, trains, trucks and cargo containers; as well as the cyber backbone that underpins the information age in which we live. The security measures we have been

cobbling together are hardly fit to deter amateur thieves, vandals and hackers, never mind determined terrorists. Worse still, small improvements are often oversold as giant steps forward, lowering the guard of average citizens as they carry on their daily routine with an unwarranted sense of confidence.

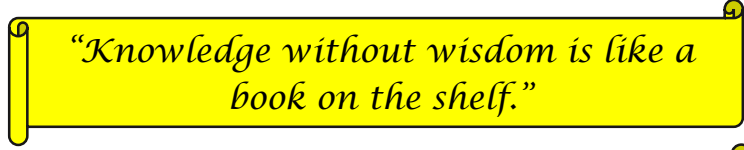
THE RULES OF CLASSIC DEBATE

Several times a year, I'm asked questions about our rules. The usual answer is that we don't have many "rules" but that there are norms that we follow. This chapter attempts to clarify some of our rules and norms.

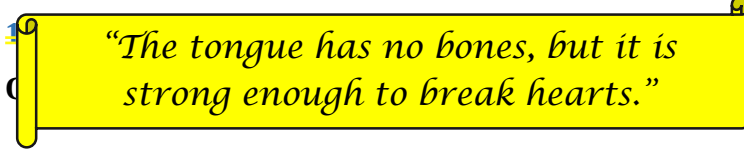
If you have other questions, please e-mail **emmasebitjose@gmail.com** and we can add other clarifications in the future.



"The truth may be stretched, but it never breaks."



"Knowledge without wisdom is like a book on the shelf."

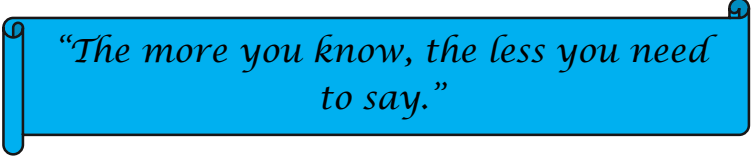


"The tongue has no bones, but it is strong enough to break hearts."

A. This IS a RULE. When evidence is presented, the author, author's qualifications, publication, and complete date must be presented. If this information is unavailable (e.g. no publication date is found on a web report or no qualifications are available for the author), it would not need to be presented, but the debater should note (on paper, not aloud) that the information was unavailable. Also it is "illegal" to not offer a full source citation the first time a source is used. If a source is used more than once, it is acceptable to give the author's name and say "previously cited."

Q. What if a team doesn't provide full source citations?

A. The judge should view evidence that is not properly cited as lacking credibility. The opposing team may point out the lack of source information and/or the judge may arrive at this conclusion on his/her own.



"The more you know, the less you need to say."

Prep Time

Q. If the team that speaks next chooses to waive their prep time, does the other team have a choice as to whether prep time is waived?

A. No. The team that is speaking next has control of the prep time and may waive it when they are prepared to speak.

New Arguments in Rebuttals

Q. When can debaters bring up new evidence and arguments in the debate?

A. This is more of a gray area. The general rule of thumb is that the opposition deserves a fair chance to respond to any argument and that “new arguments” should not be sprung later in the debate. All main ideas in the debate should be raised in the first four speeches (either in constructive or in the first opportunity to respond to the opponent’s constructive). After this point, evidence should be only presented to bolster arguments that have already been made and supported. Similarly, the arguments made should be in support of arguments already made. A few examples might help to clarify this:

Example A: The affirmative and negative teams have been going back and forth on the issue of whether a handgun ban is enforceable. Each has read evidence. In 2AR the affirmative team reads an additional evidence card to show an example of where a ban has been effectively enforced. This is okay if they had made and supported this argument earlier in the debate and the evidence is presented to try to clinch the point. This is considered “new” and therefore inadmissible if this point had not been raised in the 1AR (previous affirmative speech).

Example B: The negative team has been arguing all round that the handgun ban would cause a rise in crime. The affirmative response has been that this argument has not been supported with any evidence. Finally, in 2NR, the negative team reads evidence. This is not acceptable because the affirmative team would not have adequate time to respond—the evidence should have been presented in the negative constructive or in the 1NR in response to the affirmative case.

Example C: Both teams have been arguing back and forth about the true cost of a handgun ban. Both have read evidence to support their view. In 2AR, the affirmative presents another card to show that a “consensus” of experts

agree on a particular cost. This is admissible because the argument had been made throughout the debate and the affirmative was attempting to clinch the argument by presenting more evidence.

Example D: The negative team argues that the handgun ban will leave people defenseless and that people have a right to self-defense. The affirmative counters with a series of arguments to disprove this negative argument. In the next speech, the negative abandons the original argument and shifts the focus to the argument that the cost of gun buyback programs would be too high. Assuming that this cost argument wasn't presented in the first four speeches, this is a new argument and is not admissible.

Delivery

Q. What if my opponent speaks so fast that I have trouble understanding him/her?

A. The ballot states that “Any team or debater who speaks rapidly to gain a competitive advantage should be given an automatic loss.” With time limits, it is tempting for a team to speak extra fast in order to get more points in their speech. This technique, however, damages the quality of discourse and public speaking and is not allowed.

2. Verbal Communication

Effective verbal communication skills include more than just talking. Verbal communication involves both how messages are transmitted and how they are received. Thus, once the debater has a clear idea or argument that s/he wants to express, s/he has to be able to deliver them effectively. In this section, we will deal with the effective verbal communication skills.

The Voice

Our voice is our primary instrument in public speaking. Thus, we need to make good use of our voice to convey a message effectively. The way we sound like when we speak can make our words come alive. Most important of all, every voice projects the personality of its speaker. There are many aspects of the voice that are important in public speaking, including projection, pitch, pace, tone and articulation.

Projection: The projection of the voice is the volume of the voice and the ability to use the voice in a proper manner in order to be heard clearly. We should vary our projection based on audience and the point we are making. For example, wide projection is suitable for large audiences

when not assisted by amplification. Placing greater emphasis on a word or phrase, by speaking more loudly can also capture the attention of our audience. However, it will be appropriate to speak moderately or softly, with a close projection if in a small group. This is also a good technique to attract attention to a specific point, because it causes the audience to lean forward and focus intently on what is being said.

Pitch: The pitch of our voice relates to how high or low it sounds. Some people have a naturally high pitch whilst others may have a naturally low pitch. We are not required to change the overall pitch of our voice –that’s simply the way we speak. However, speakers who vary their pitch depending on the point they are making can usually have greater impact with their audience. For example, a high pitch can be appropriate to relay excitement or shock, whilst a low pitch might relay disappointment or sarcasm.

Pace: When we’re speaking quickly, it appears to be exciting for the audience initially, but after few minutes, it stops being stimulating and becomes overwhelming. On the other side, when we are speaking slowly, it can grab the audience’s attention and interest and help them process every word, but a whole talk at a slow pace will annoy the

audience: they will lose interest while waiting for you to get to the point. That's why, the best way to mix it up! Keep most of our speech in the ordinary range of conversations, then change the pace to highlight points in the message and affect the audience's emotions. An important aspect of pace is the use of space. Pausing indicates to the audience the end of an idea or point. It allows them an opportunity to consider the point and to prepare for what is to come.

The pause should only be brief, as too long a pause may suggest we have lost track of our thoughts. Pauses after an important point can also be used to resonate the point amongst an audience.

Tone: We can convey many emotions with our voice. This is referred to as tone. Our tone is influenced by the volume, projection and pitch of our voice. By placing emphasis on a particular word, phrase or sentence, we can convey specific emotions and feelings. An overall presentation can also have a tone. For example, the way we use our voice can give a presentation a friendly, empathetic or warm tone. Alternatively, the presentation may have a combative or abrasive tone. We should always be mindful of the tone of

a presentation and ensure that it is suitable to deliver the desired effect to the point being made and the listener.

Expression

Verbal communication is not only about the quality of our voice. It is also shaped by what we express and the way in which we express it. Expression includes the way we pronounce and enunciate words, language and accent, and style. They all work together with our voice to complete expression in a presentation. We should always be mindful of how these factors influence the way we present and the effect they leave with an audience.

Pronunciation: refers to the ability to use the proper stress, rhythm and intonation of a word in a language spoken. Be careful to pronounce words in a way that they will be recognizable to the audience. Repeatedly mispronouncing a word or expression may indicate that the speaker is not sufficiently familiar with the topic on which he/she is speaking or did not adequately prepare for the presentation. This also will make the audience bored as they are forced to focus more to understand what the speaker is saying.

Enunciation: is how you speak the words, and how clearly those words come out of your mouth. When you enunciate

clearly, you're going to show your teeth. When you strengthen your enunciation, your listeners will make a better impression of you when you talk and will be better able to concentrate on the message you are sending, instead of getting distracted by the way you express yourself.

Language and Accent: We should always present in a language with which we are familiar and comfortable to the listener. This will show the person's true ability and preparedness. Also, we should be careful to use diction that is in line with the language in which we are presenting. It is a common fault to incorporate words and expressions from a different language into speech.

We should be mindful that this may be confusing to an audience. If this is the case, try to translate the words in the language that is understood by the audience. As for the accent, be mindful of our audience, and speak in such a way that would maximize their ability to understand. This may mean speaking slowly and being more careful with pronunciations and enunciation.

Style: Each speaker has his/her own speaking style. The most important of all is to never imitate the style of any other speaker, but rather to develop our own style.

This can be done through experience. Be authentic, simple, accept yourself and always practice.

3. Non-verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication refers to gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, body language, posture, and other ways people can communicate without using language.

Eye Contact

Eye contact is a particularly important type of nonverbal communication. Many things can be communicated by the way you look at someone, including interest, affection, hostility or attraction. Eye contact indicates that we are focused on the audience, and equally, their eye contact indicates to us that they are paying attention. When we make eye contact with our audience, we are better able to make a connection with them and build and maintain their trust. Good eye contact reflects the confidence of a speaker and impacts their persuasiveness in argument.

Facial Expressions

The human face is highly expressive, capable of conveying countless feelings without saying a single word. Facial expressions including smiling, frowning, grimacing, raised

eyebrows etc. can be used to accentuate a point that is being made.

Facial expressions should always be measured and appropriate. We should avoid excessive, theatrical expressions as they can be distracting to what is being said.

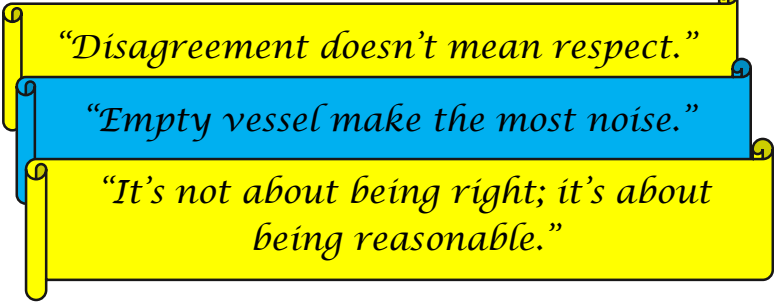
Body Language

The way you move and carry yourself conveys to the world a wealth of information. When you practice your speech, it is also important to work on your body language. The way you move your head during your speech is also important. When you tilt your head to the side, for example, it may mean you are interested or listening intently. It can mean you 're tired when you lower your head. If you look up at the ceiling while you're talking, that means that you are trying to stop making eye contact with your audience



THE SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, adopted by the United Nations in 2015, includes 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), also known as the Global Goals, which provides a shared blueprint to achieve a better and sustainable future and calls for an urgent universal action to end poverty, improve health and education, reduce inequality, and spur economic growth and among many others. The 17 Goals are all interconnected whereby they recognize that impact in one area will affect outcomes in others, and that development must be balanced among the three main pillars of sustainability: economic, social, and environmental. These goals should be achieved by 2030.



“Disagreement doesn’t mean respect.”

“Empty vessel make the most noise.”

“It’s not about being right; it’s about being reasonable.”

Goal 1 - No Poverty: End Poverty in all its forms everywhere

Goal 2 – Zero Hunger: End Hunger and ensure access by all people

Goal 3 – Good Health and Well-Being: Ensure healthy lives and promote well-being for all at all ages

Goal 4 – Quality Education: Improve people’s lives and sustainable development through a quality education

Goal 5 – Gender Equality: Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls

Goal 6 – Clean Water and Sanitation: Ensure access to water and sanitation for all

Goal 7- Affordable and Clean Energy: Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable, and modern energy

Goal 8 – Decent Work and Economic Growth: Promote inclusive and sustainable economic growth, employment, and decent work for all

Goal 9 – Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure: Build resilient infrastructure, promote sustainable industrialization and foster innovation

Goal 10 – Reduced Inequalities: Reduce inequality within and among countries

Goal 11 – Sustainable Cities and Communities: Make cities inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable

Goal 12 – Responsible Production and Consumption: Ensure sustainable consumption and production patterns

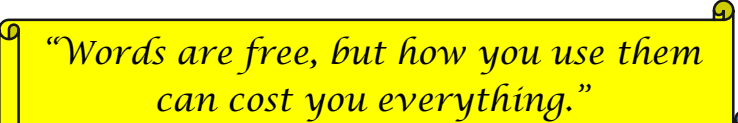
Goal 13 – Climate Action: Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts

Goal 14 – Life Below Water: Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas and marine resources

Goal 15 – Life on Land: Sustainably manage forests, combat desertification, halt and reverse land degradation, halt biodiversity loss

Goal 16 – Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions: Promote just, peaceful and inclusive societies

Goal 17 – Partnerships: Revitalize the global partnership for sustainable development



“Words are free, but how you use them can cost you everything.”



“Respect the argument, not just the speaker.”



“Master the art of listening, and you’ll master the art of debate.”

“A strong debater doesn’t fear tough questions; they embrace them.”

“An argument without evidence is like a house without a foundation.”

“Logic wins’ battles, but emotion wins’ hearts.”

Objective

The objective of this guide is to provide key tips on guaranteeing debate club sustainability for clubs established in various institution.

The guide focuses on two core parts: the survival essentials to establish and sustain the club and the internal management that supports this establishment and further guarantees the sustainability of the club.

Part I: Survival Essentials

Why- Raison Debate

Like any organization, each debate club needs a reason behind its establishment, i.e. why is this club being established? The reason can be as simple as passion for debate and dialogue or even further to include promoting civic engagement, encouraging youth involvement in governance and policy making, contributing to the Sustainable Development Goals, solving communal problems, etc.

The reason could be based on the founders' main interest in addition to the communal need. For instance, if the club is

being established in the university, what is the need of your university students? On the other hand, this reason could change if the club is part of an NGO, municipality, or simply the community. As such, the club does not need to be focused merely on debate; instead, it could focus on any topic or interest and use debate as a tool to achieve the aim of the club.

For instance, medical students at a university can form a medical club, but then use debate to create awareness on medical topics.

Who- Memberships and Target Audience

Every club should identify their membership criteria in alignment with their reason for the debate club. For instance, if the reason behind the club establishment is to empower youth, members of the club are to be part of the youth category. On the other hand, the target audience of the club can be, but is not limited to, the members of the club. For example, in the case of a debate club, the target audience can be the debaters, but also community members who attend the debates in order to raise their awareness on different issues. The members and target audience are essential elements to the sustainability of the club and will govern club activities.

What- Activities

The activities run by the club are primarily governed by the club's identity which is comprised of the club's objective, members, and target audience. Activities of clubs established under the program can be primarily focused on debate but can also include other diverse activities based on the club's projection. Also, debate can be used as a tool for broader activities than a mere public debate or debate championship such as high level political, social, economic, or environmental panels or forums, advocacy campaigns, electoral campaigns, movie/book discussions, etc.

Where- Meeting Venues

In order to guarantee its sustainability, the debate club should have one or more fixed venues for their meetings and activities. Examples of venues include municipality public halls to be booked prior to meetings and activities, university premises, NGO premises within the community, or local training venues.

When- Meeting Times

Meeting times are to be agreed among cabinet members. In general, the club should meet on a regular basis in order to plan activities and discuss work progress. Meetings can be

fixed (weekly, fortnightly, or monthly) or determined on a need basis.

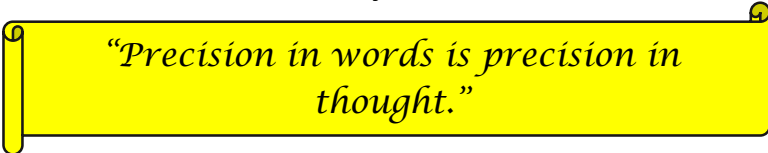
Part II: Internal Management

Club Name

The name of the club is indicative of its objective and its function, i.e. the activities which it holds. The name should be simple yet creative. If the core focus is debate, the club can be named as follows: name of community Debate Club. On the other hand, if the club uses debate as a tool to empower women voices, it could be named: name of community Women Voices or Women in Debate/Decision-making.

Club Visibility

It is highly recommended for established clubs to have a logo and theme which represents the club. Both the logo and theme should be inspired by the club's identity and portray a clear message in a creative way. For example, if the club is focused on youth empowerment, the theme used in branding should be colorful and uses youthful colors.



“Precision in words is precision in thought.”

Club Vision

It is essential for every established club to have a clear vision set at the beginning of their journey. The vision of the club, which is primarily inspired by the club's identity, is the desired future position of the club. It is the ultimate long-term goal that the club seeks to achieve. For instance, if the reason behind the establishment of the club is to empower young people, the vision of the club could be to develop a generation of youth who are capable of leading change in their societies.

Club Mission

It is also essential for every established club to have a clear mission set at the beginning of their journey. The mission of the club is defined by the objectives of the club and the approach to reach those objectives. It is the short-term goals that need to be achieved in order to achieve the vision. For instance, the mission associated with the vision set above could be to empower youth voices through providing them with the skills and tools needed to voice their opinions about pressing issues. This is the means by which the vision will be achieved or the objective of the club; however, we also need to specify how we will reach this objective. This could be in the following form: conducting weekly trainings to

young people on debate skills, organizing monthly roundtable discussions among young people and decision makers, etc.

Club Location

Based on the availability of resources through funds, sponsorships, or partnerships, the club may or may not have a private fixed location. However, as mentioned in

Part I of this guide, it is essential for the club to have avenue available for meetings and events.

Club Resources

There are many ways by which the club can acquire resources to guarantee their sustainability; these include, but are not limited to:

1. Joining Fees and Yearly Membership Fees: this amount can be determined according to the context, availability of other resources, and types of activities planned.
2. Governmental Funds
3. Grants from Embassies or Local and International NGOs
4. Fees gathered from Events
5. Sponsorships for Events

Club Partnerships

In order to guarantee its sustainability, it is important for the club to establish partnerships. These partnerships could be general, to provide support for the club on a regular basis, or event specific to support with a certain need during an event.

Prior to seeking partnerships, it is crucial for the club to identify their stakeholders in order to use the most powerful stakeholders early on in the establishment of the club or in events. Not only does this make it more likely that they will support you in the future, but their input can also aid the quality of your activities. Using these powerful stakeholders can assist with gaining the correct level of resources for your club. Once the key stakeholders are identified, plot their position on the influence/interest grid shown below:



Using your

influence/interest grid to drive your communications strategy ensures that stakeholders receive the correct level of information at the right time, the earlier you start

communicating with your stakeholders the better their understanding of the club and its benefits. Plot stakeholder's position on the grid above using the following guidelines:

- High influence, interested people: these are the people you must fully engage and make the greatest efforts with e.g. A head of department, who represents the users/customers
- High influence, less interested people: provide sufficient information to these people to ensure that they are up to date but not overwhelmed with data e.g. the Accountable Body (Management Board or Operations Committee)
- Low influence, interested people: keep these people adequately informed, talk to them to ensure that no major issues arise. These people can help with the detail of the club's activities e.g. End Users, other Project Managers, Business Community
- Low influence, less interested people: provide these people with minimal communication to prevent boredom e.g. other departmental members, teams unaffected by the change.

When plotting the stakeholder's position on your grid, it is worthwhile establishing who will be advocates/supporters of your activities and who will be blockers/critics of them. Use color coding to identify which of these two groups the

stakeholder belongs – e.g. green for advocates/supporters and red for dis-interested/unsupportive. The following questions help you to understand their needs/drivers and grouping and assist in establishing the best way to engage them in your club or activity:

- What financial or emotional interest do they have in the outcome of your work – is it positive or negative?
- What motivates them most of all?
- What support do you want from them?
- What information do they want from you?
- How do they want to receive information from you – what is the best way of communicating your message to them (this will input into your communications plan)?
- What is their current opinion of your work and is it based on good information?
- Who influences their opinions generally and who influences their opinion of you?
- If they are not likely to be positive what will win them round to give their support?

- If you are unlikely to win around, then how will you manage their opposition?
- Who else might be influenced by their opinions and decide if they need to become stakeholders in their own right?

Club Membership

Membership criteria are to be determined by the club management. The criteria can include an age range, fields of interest/expertise, alignment with the club's vision and mission, etc. Memberships can be received via an online or print form that is submitted to the governing board to be approved.

Members have the right to resign from the club through providing a written resignation to the club's secretary during the club's meeting. In case the member resigns after 4 months of the start of the financial year, the member should pay the yearly membership fees for that year. Also, in case the resigned member wishes to join the club again, he/she should fill in the membership form again and is subject to all membership criteria.

On the other hand, the governance board has the right to suspend any members in the following cases:

- His/her actions violate the mission and values of the club;
- He/she no longer satisfies the membership criteria;
- He/she is not committed to paying membership fees on time; and
- He/she is not committed to attending the club's meetings.

Club Governance Structure

The club is to be formed of the two following boards:

1. General Assembly: which includes all members of the club.
2. Administrative Body: which includes 9 members who are elected by the general assembly through a secret ballot. In order to conduct the elections, one-third of the general assembly members who have paid their annual contributions six months prior to the date of the elections should be present. The mandate of the administrative body is two years. The election session is moderated by a body of at least three members of the general assembly headed by the oldest member.

The elected administrative body then meets under the chairmanship of the oldest member and selects among its members a president, a vice president, a secretary, and a

treasurer. A maximum of two positions may be assigned to one member of the administrative body, except for the right to decide and implement the disbursement of funds.

The Founding Body of the club, which constitutes its founders, shall exercise the powers of the administrative body for a period of one year from the date of the club establishment. The latter should complete the procedures for establishing the club and call for the election of a new administrative body within one year of the date of establishment.

The above governance structure can be amended by a decision of the Extraordinary General Assembly according to the rules listed in the internal regulations, and amendments are not approved except by a majority of two-thirds of the votes of the members present or representatives. The quorum shall be secured in the presence of the absolute majority of the members who have paid their contributions for the past two years.

Club Internal Regulations

1. General Assembly

Authority: The General Assembly has the authority to decide and its decisions do not accept any means of revision except as stipulated by the club laws.

Composition: The General Assembly consists of all the members who have been registered in the club for more than three months prior to the meeting of the relevant general assembly, and who pay their annual contributions, unless the Administrative Body exempts a particular member or group of members from this duty by reasoned decisions.

Meetings:

a. The president or vice president of the Administrative Body chairs the sessions of the general assembly with the exception of the meetings devoted to the election of the Administrative Body where the oldest member of the General Assembly chairs the meeting.

b. The Administrative Body shall fix the date of the General Assembly's meetings and agenda and notify all members of the General Assembly at least fifteen days before the date of the meeting.

c. Any member of the General Assembly has the right to suggest the topics that s/he wishes to discuss during the meetings of the General Assembly, provided that s/he

communicates these issues to the Administrative Body at least one week before the date of the General Assembly meeting date.

d. Each member of the General Assembly has the right to speak on any of the topics on the agenda.

e. Discussions may be concluded after the General Assembly approves a proposal in this regard submitted by one of the members.

f. Decisions shall be taken by absolute majority of the votes of the members present or representatives and by show of hands.

g. A vote is accepted as a representation under a written authorization provided for that reason, given that this authorization is submitted to the secretary no less than seven days before the meeting. A member shall not be entitled to represent more than two persons affiliated with the club.

h. Members who fail to pay their financial obligations (contributions) six months before the election date are not eligible to vote.

i. Members whose membership did not exceed six months are not eligible to vote.

Ordinary General Assembly:

a. The General Assembly meets at an annual ordinary meeting during the first three months of the year at the invitation of the President of the Administrative Body. If the President fails to invite the General Assembly to meet during this period, it shall be convened by virtue of the invitation of any member of the administrative body, the elderly person, or the association's auditor (if any) according to the conditions specified in this system.

b. The Ordinary General Assembly can also be called to extraordinary meetings during the year whenever the need arises. This call is made, either at the request of the President or the decision of the majority of the members of the Administrative Body or one third of the members of the club who are entitled to vote. The meeting is held at the place and time specified by the Administrative Body.

c. In all the cases mentioned above, an invitation shall be sent to attend the meeting within a period of no less than fifteen days and a maximum of thirty days from the date of the session. The invitation shall state the reasons for holding this meeting, its location, time, and agenda.

d. The Ordinary General Assembly is considered legal in the presence of half of the members who composes it plus one. If the quorum is not complete, the General Assembly is automatically invited to another meeting, held a week after the first meeting. Then the Ordinary General Assembly will be legal, regardless of the number of members present or represented.

e. The Ordinary General Assembly shall assume the following tasks and authorities:

1. Researching and discussing the general annual report and taking appropriate decisions in this regard.

2. Auditing and discussing the annual financial report and taking the appropriate decisions in this regard, so that the accounts of the past fiscal year and the budget and account of the subsequent fiscal year are approved.

3. Determining the annual contribution fee.

4. Appointing the club's financial auditor based on the proposal of the Administrative Body.

5. Electing members of the Administrative Body.

6. Researching and discussing all issues on the agenda of the meeting that are in conformity with applicable regulations and taking appropriate decisions in this regard.

Extraordinary General Assembly:

a. The Extraordinary General Assembly is called to a meeting, either to amend the club's regulations or to dissolve the club.

b. The meeting of the Extraordinary General Assembly is either at the suggestion of the Administrative Body or at the request of 20% of the members of the General Assembly. In the latter case, the President of the club or the club's auditor (if available), if the president fails to do so, is obligated to invite the General Assembly to convene within a period of one month that is valid from the date of receipt of the request to the secretariat.

c. The agenda of the meeting is to be included in the invitation which is notified to the members a month before the date of the General Assembly meeting.

d. The Extraordinary General Assembly is not considered legal, except in the presence of the absolute majority of its members.

e. If the quorum is not secured, the General Assembly shall be invited again after the end of a one-month period with the same agenda. Its meeting will not be valid then except in the presence of at least one third of its members.

f. If this quorum is not secured, then the agenda is returned, and the invitation to the General Assembly is no longer permissible for the same subjects, except after the expiration of a year, in accordance with the same conditions and principles above.

g. When the Extraordinary General Assembly is called to dissolve the club, the provisions

mentioned under the “Club Closure” sections are observed.

2. Administrative Body Composition:

a. Supervision and management of the club is entrusted to the administrative body which is constituted of 9 elected members. The Extraordinary General Assembly is entitled, upon

the proposal of the Administrative Body, to reduce

or increase the number of members of the Administrative Body.

b. Members of the Administrative Body assume the following permanent responsibilities in the capacity of an executive body: the president, vice president, secretary, and a treasurer. The Administrative Body also has the right to create positions or other responsibilities or to create specialized committees when the need arises, and it chooses whoever heads its membership and defines its tasks.

Duties:

a. Strives to achieve the goals of the club, the proper application of its regulations, and the practice of its activities within the framework of its goals, as well as the implementation of General Assembly decisions.

b. Drafts and implements the budget after its approval by the General Assembly in addition to proposing the annual membership fees.

c. Decides to set up committees according to the need of the club and within the spirit of its regulations.

d. Sets a plan for the cycle of activities of the club and monitors its implementation.

e. Sets the agenda for the General Assembly meetings.

f. Monitors the work of the treasurer.

g. Takes the decision to suspend any member in case s/he acts in a way that is detrimental to the club and its values.

h. Sets the administrative systems necessary to organize the club's work and affairs according to what it deems necessary from time to time, given that the decisions of the administrative body do not contradict the spirit of the association's regulations and texts.

i. Guarantees the auditing of the treasurer's accounts and has full power to decide all matters related to the club and its activities. Its decisions are final within its powers; for every matter outside its powers, a return to the General Assembly is mandatory.

Electoral Process:

a. The members of the Administrative Body are elected every two years from among the members of the club who have paid their contributions according to what is agreed in this system.

Their term of office is two years' subject to renewal by the end of the term (with the exception of the president, who cannot run for the presidency until after the lapse of two years after the end of his assumption of his presidential duties and within the conditions and criteria set by the club).

On this basis, an annual Ordinary General Assembly holds the election by secret ballot during May or at another date that the Administrative Body may appoint for extraordinary reasons, and the general assembly votes on it by two-thirds (2/3) of the attendees without specifying the positions and functions of each member.

Members do not receive any salary or fee remuneration as a result of carrying out their stated tasks.

b. The election results should be announced immediately after the counting is completed, and the candidates who obtain the largest number of votes from the voters will be considered winners.

If two candidates are equal in the number of votes, the oldest candidate in his/her affiliation with the club is considered a winner, and if they are equal in that, the older candidate wins.

c. Upon the election of its members, the Administrative Body selects each of the following functions: the president, vice president, secretary, and treasurer.

d. Upon electing the Administrative Body, the latter shall unanimously appoint the Disciplinary Body which constitutes three of the club's members. It is within the

competence of the Disciplinary Body to consider any violation or conduct of any affiliate member that is not in compliance with the club's regulations. This body reports to the Administrative Body which is responsible for taking the necessary measures against the violating member.

e. The Administrative Body shall occupy any vacant position due to the death or resignation of one of the members, the transfer of his/her work outside Lebanon, or any other reason through calling for the candidate or candidates who did not win, yet obtained the majority of votes in the last general elections.

f. If more than a third of the memberships in the Administrative Body are vacant while there is still more than six months remaining in the term of the Administrative Body, an Ordinary General Assembly should be duly invited to elect members to fill the vacancy.

g. In all cases, the President and members of the Administrative Body continue to exercise their roles until the new members are elected.

h. In the cases that the President of the Administrative Body dies or is incapable of performing their duty due to sickness or any other reason, the Administrative Body appoints the

Vice-President as a President for the remaining time of the term and elects from its members a new Vice-President.

Candidacy Regulations:

a. Any of the members of the club has the right to run for the elections of the Administrative Body, provided that the contributions due from them are duly paid, and that s/he has previously paid at least two consecutive contributions. In this context, he shall submit his nomination to the secretary through a written request within fifteen days before the nomination closing date. Nomination applications are considered by a committee, appointed by the members of the Administrative Body to accept the nominations, at least one month before the date of the meeting for the election, provided that its members are not less than three and not more than five and the majority of them are outside the members of the Administrative body and its employees. The task of this committee is to check the applicability of the candidates to all statutory requirements. No nomination is accepted unless it meets these conditions. The nomination door is closed five days before the elections.

b. The aforementioned committee must submit to 30 the Administrative Body, in writing, within a period of no less

than five days before the date of the elections, a list of the names of those whose nomination for membership was considered regular and fundamentalist.

c. The Secretary publishes, at least ten days before the date of the election, a preliminary table with the names of the candidates, and another table with the names of the members included in the General Assembly, and accepts objections until five days before the election date. Afterwards, the list becomes final.

Meetings:

a. The Administrative Board shall convene, at the invitation of its President, at least twelve meetings per year (including the annual regular meeting). It can meet whenever the need arises, either by the invitation of the president or at the initiative of the majority of the members of the Administrative Body, given that the quorum will not be considered complete unless half of its members are present.

b. The administrative body must specify, at the beginning of each semester, the dates of the periodic meetings, so that they are notified to their members via e-mail, and therefore, it is only necessary to remind each member of the appointed date by the available means at the time. In the event of a

special meeting, the member must be notified a week before while stating the reasons for holding this special meeting.

c. The members of the Administrative Body must attend the meetings. If one of the members fails to attend the meetings three times in a row without a legitimate excuse, the Administrative Body will meet in an extraordinary session and take the appropriate action against him, where if deemed necessary, can drop his/her membership from the Administrative Body.

Suspension of its Members:

a. Any of the members of the Administrative Body can be suspended in case s/he fails to perform their duties, violates the regulations of the club, or exceeds the limits of authority.

b. This dismissal shall be decided upon by the General Assembly convened in this regard at the invitation of the President or three members of the Administrative Body, by secret ballot, by a majority of two-thirds of the affiliated members who compose it legally.

c. The concerned member attends this meeting but does not participate in the voting process.

Legal Quorum:

The quorum is considered legal in the meetings of the Administrative Body if half of its members are present.

Decisions are taken by the majority of those present.

Authorities of the President:

In this capacity, the President performs the following tasks:

1. Represents the club with others and with all national, international, political, administrative, judicial, and military authorities, and is responsible for the proper functioning of the club's work and its compliance with the applicable laws and regulations.
2. Invites the sessions of the Administrative Body and the Ordinary and Extraordinary General Assemblies and presides over them (except in cases where these regulations stipulate otherwise).
3. Signs with the Secretary the minutes of the meetings of the General Assembly and the Administrative Body and all official transactions belonging to the club.
4. Chairs the committee meetings and is an advisory member therein, with the exception of the Nominations Committee.
5. Opens the financial accounts in the name of the club and withdraws money from them provided that his/her signature

and that of the club's treasure are obligatory for these two operations.

Authorities of the Vice-President:

The Vice President shall assume all the tasks and powers of the President in the event of his/her absence (out of illness or for a legitimate excuse) or with his/her authorization. In the aforementioned cases, s/he shall preside over all the meetings of both the General Assembly and the Administrative Body.

Authorities of the Secretary:

The Secretary is responsible for the following tasks:

1. Supervises the preservation and organisation of all legal records, from members' records to records of the General Assembly and Administrative Body meeting minutes which s/he signs along with the President or Vice-President.
2. Maintains and organises a general record with the names of members and their different roles.
3. Receives and confines incoming correspondence and communications.
4. Sends invitations and informs the club's decisions to the concerned parties.

5. Takes the position of treasurer in his absence.
6. Reports annually on the work done during the year at the annual general meeting.

Authorities of the Treasurer:

All funds of the club are pledged to the treasurer where he supervises:

1. Organizing the club's accounts records.
2. Receiving subscriptions, gifts, donations, and sponsorships from different parties.
3. Paying all transfers and securities in accordance with the decisions of the Administrative Body.
4. Providing a statement of the club's accounts whenever the need arises.
5. Paying the value of purchases and expenses.
6. Preserving the club's resources.
7. Preparing a detailed report on the state of the club's financial status and presents it at the annual general meeting.

3. Amendments

These regulations may be amended by a decision of the Extraordinary General Assembly, according to the rules included in this procedure in force. The amendments are approved only by a majority of two-thirds of the votes of the members present or representatives. The quorum shall be secured in the presence of the absolute majority of the club members who have paid their contributions for the past two years.

4. Other Regulations

Any ten gathered members are entitled to submit a written accusation to the Administrative Body against any member who has acted in a way that is detrimental to the interests of the club or violated its principles. Once the complaint has been submitted to the Administrative Body, this complaint is communicated to the concerned party, giving him/her a period of twenty days before the date of the Supreme Disciplinary Body meeting to consider it. A member has the right to defend his/her actions, and in the event that the Administrative Body is convinced of the validity of the complaint and vote by majority on its authenticity, the body has the right to drop his/her membership or impose on him/her the procedure deemed appropriate.

Club Dissolving

A proposal to dissolve the club can be made by the Administrative Body by a majority of two-thirds of the members who compose it legally or by the absolute majority of the members of the General Assembly. The Extraordinary General Assembly is called according to the principles specified in the regulations, and the quorum is not complete in this meeting except in the presence or representation of two-thirds of the members of the General Assembly who are registered on the list of members and whose contributions are paid.

If the decision is taken to dissolve the club, the General Assembly shall nominate one person or several persons who are responsible for liquidating the club's properties and funds and net assets shall be transferred to the person decided by the Administrative Body at that time, otherwise, and in the event of inaction or impossibility, all assets are given to the Lebanese Red Cross



"Give someone a fair hearing." – Listen to someone's perspective without bias

"Add fuel to the fire." – Make a heated situation more intense

"Make waves." – Cause change or controversy

Epilogue

As we close **Debate Foundation: Volume 1**, it is essential to reflect on the journey we've undertaken together. What began as an exploration of the core principles of debate has, hopefully, evolved into a deeper understanding of its true purpose: to foster dialogue, refine critical thinking, and empower individuals to express their ideas with clarity and conviction.

Throughout this book, we've broken down the tools and techniques that make up the foundation of effective debate. From constructing persuasive arguments to handling objections, you have gained insights that will serve you in countless settings—whether in the classroom, in professional environments, or in the everyday conversations that shape our world.

But this is just the beginning. The skills you've learned here are not meant to be confined to these pages alone. Debate is an ongoing practice, and mastery comes with continuous application and refinement. As you continue to engage with the world around you, remember that debate is not simply about "winning" an argument; it's about listening, challenging assumptions, and learning from those with whom you disagree.

I encourage you to keep questioning, keep practicing, and keep striving to become a more effective communicator. With every debate you engage in, you will become a better thinker, a more compelling speaker, and an advocate for your ideas.

As you move forward, take the lessons and skills from this book and apply them to your life. Engage in thoughtful conversations, foster understanding, and, most importantly, never stop learning. The world of debate is vast, and the opportunities to grow within it are endless.

Thank you for joining me on this foundational journey. I hope you feel empowered to continue your exploration, armed with the knowledge and confidence to shape the conversations that matter most.

The stage is now yours. Let the debates continue.

Emmanuel Sebit Joseph

Date _____

Appendix A: Sample Debate Topics

1. The impact of social media on political discourse

2. The ethics of artificial intelligence
3. Should college education be free for all?
4. The role of government in regulating climate change
5. Should animals be used for scientific research?

Appendix B: Debate Structure Templates

Constructing a Case

- Introduction
- Define key terms
- Present arguments
- Provide evidence
- Counter-arguments
- Conclusion

Rebuttal Structure

- Acknowledge opponent's points
- Challenge their reasoning
- Present stronger evidence
- Reaffirm your position

Appendix C: Further Reading and Resources

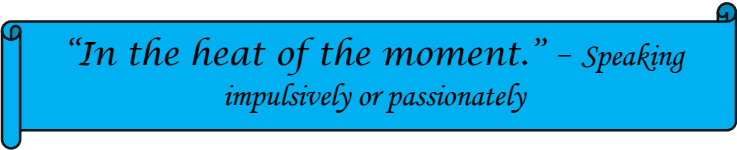
- “The Art of Argument: A Guide to Critical Thinking” by John Doe
- “Thank You for Arguing” by Jay Heinrichs
- Online platforms for debate practice: Debate.org, Kialo
- Debater training manual full version Young Med Voices
- www.debatingsa.com.au
- A Student’s Guide to Classic Debate Competition by Todd Hering 2000 Revised 2007.



*“Level playing field.” – Ensure fairness in
debate or discussion.*

Glossary of Debate Terms

- **Affirmative:** The side in a debate that supports the resolution or topic being debated.
- **Rebuttal:** A response to an argument made by the opposing side, aimed at countering or discrediting their points.
- **Resolution:** The statement or proposition that is being debated. For example, "The government should regulate social media platforms."
- **Fallacy:** A flaw in reasoning that weakens an argument. Common fallacies include ad hominem, strawman, and false dichotomy.
- **Cross-examination:** A phase in a debate where one side questions the opposing team to challenge their arguments.
- **Framework:** The lens through which a debate should be viewed, often referring to the criteria that judges use to evaluate arguments.



*"In the heat of the moment." – Speaking
impulsively or passionately*

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Acronyms and Abbreviations

THB- This house believes

THBT- This house believes that.....

THW- This house will/would.....

1A, 2A, 3A- First, second and third affirmative respectively.

1N, 2N, 3N- First, second and that Negative respectively.

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